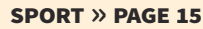


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INBRIEF



Prince of Arcot, industrialist call on Chief Minister Vijay

The Prince of Arcot, Nawab Mohammed Abdul Ali, called on Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay at the Secretariat on Tuesday. Mr. Ali, along with his wife Begum Sayeeda Abdul Ali and family members, congratulated Mr. Vijay on his victory in the Assembly election, and also held a discussion with him. Separately, Dheeraj G. Hinduja, chairman of Ashok Leyland, also called on the Chief Minister.

Man held for sharing photos of woman on social media

The Cyber Crime Wing of the Tambaram city police arrested a man for allegedly circulating morphed pictures of a woman on social media for money. Following a complaint from the woman, the Central Crime Branch Cyber Crime Wing of Tambaram city police analysed data from Instagram and Telegram, and identified the accused as Bhuvanesh Kumar of Somangalam. The accused had allegedly downloaded the woman's photographs from social media, morphed them into obscene images and sold them through Instagram and Telegram, police said. The police also seized a mobile phone and laptop allegedly used for committing the offence.

History-sheeter among four arrested for robbing techie

The CMBT police have arrested four persons, including a history-sheeter, for allegedly assaulting and robbing Shyam Dhan Ghoshal, 30, a software engineer, of his laptop and mobile phone near 100-Foot Road in Arumbakkam while he walking towards his hostel in Vadapalani on May 5. The accused were identified as "Pallu" Vicky, 30, of Mangadu, Thirupathi, a college student, Gautham, and Sanjay Kumar.

Commuters using MRTS demand trains every ten minutes during peak hours

Passengers say the reduced frequency has made commuting difficult for office-goers who depend on connecting trains; railway officials cite constraints due to Egmore station redevelopment works

TRACK TALES

T. Arvind
CHENNAI

Suburban rail commuters travelling between the city's northern and southern corridors have urged Southern Railway to increase the frequency of Mass Rapid Transit system (MRTS) trains during peak hours, from the present 20 minutes to 10 minutes.

Passengers travelling from Arakkonam, Tiruvalur, Avadi and other western suburbs to destinations along the MRTS corridor said the reduced frequency has made daily commuting difficult, especially for office-goers who depend on connecting suburban and MRTS services.

Long wait

P.K. Narayanan, a commuter from Korattur travelling to Mount Road, said MRTS services earlier operated at 10-minute intervals during peak hours. "The most affected were the commuters who travel from areas such as Arakkonam, Tiruvalur, Avadi, Korattur, and Villivakkam," he said.

Commuters said changing platforms at Chennai Beach station had become stressful due to the 20-minute gap between trains.



Daily struggle: Pending issues in land transfer near Chennai Fort and track-sharing arrangements have also led to slow movement of trains between Fort and Beach stations. R. RAGU

"Most often, the Arakkonam-Beach trains halt at platform 4 or 5 at Beach. For the onward journey towards the south, say to Chepauk and Adyar, one needs to catch the MRTS train at platform 8. For people aged 50+ like me, changing platforms is exhausting," said Rajan Boopathy from Villivakkam. Often, he says, he missed the train and had to wait for another 20 minutes.

Passengers from the southern suburbs also complained of long waiting times and poor last-mile connectivity around MRTS stations. "Sometimes, when I miss the MRTS train at Velachery, instead of waiting for 20 minutes, I

take my vehicle back to OTA-Nanganallur Road Metro to reach the office on time," said S.K. Subramanya from Madipakkam.

Egmore station works

Railway officials said operational limitations linked to redevelopment works at Chennai Egmore station were affecting MRTS services. The issue intensified after MRTS services between Chennai Beach and Velachery were temporarily curtailed in August 2023 to facilitate the construction of a fourth railway line between Egmore and Chennai Beach.

Though services resumed fully in October 2024, commuters said de-

lays and bottlenecks continue.

According to railway sources, pending land transfer issues near Chennai Fort and track-sharing arrangements have also affected train movement speeds between Fort and Beach stations. While Southern Railway has upgraded several suburban services in the northern and western sections from nine-car to 12-car EMUs, many elevated MRTS stations can still accommodate only nine-car trains, limiting operational flexibility.

A senior Southern Railway official said the present arrangements were temporary and linked to the ongoing ₹842-crore Chennai Egmore redevelopment project.

"As part of the redevelopment process, operational constraints arising out of regulation of Express train services between Chennai Egmore, Tambaram and Chennai Beach have necessitated temporary adjustments in train operations," the official said.

The official added that increasing MRTS frequency was not feasible at present, but operational flexibility and infrastructure capacity were expected to improve after completion of the redevelopment works at Egmore station.



J. Kanishka and V. Bhavana with V.M. Muralidharan, Chairman, Ethiraj College for Women, on Tuesday. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

Ethiraj College offers free seats to children of sanitation workers

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

J. Kanishka is very happy to have secured a seat at her dream college, Ethiraj College for Women. The daughter of a conservancy worker and fisherman, she only had two colleges in mind and was hoping to get into Ethiraj college.

A student of N.K.T. National Girls Higher Secondary School, Kanishka had scored 420 in her Class XII exams. "I want to make my parents proud. I see them working very hard to secure a good future for us. My father goes for work at 6 a.m. and then goes to the sea in the evening. I want them to lead a comfortable life," she said after securing an admission to the BCA course. Kanishka aspires to pursue Chartered Accountancy.

V. Bhavana, daughter of another worker at Urbaser Sumeet, was thrilled to secure an admission to the B.Com stream at Ethiraj College. "I missed the cut-off and hence, I couldn't afford the self-financing op-

tion. I really hope to do so much better so that my parents and everyone who supports me are always proud," she said.

Thanks to the company's Edu Bridge Initiative, the two students, who are first generation learners, have received a free admission to the college. They received their admission letters on Tuesday at the college.

Chairman of the college V.M. Muralidharan said that there are a lot of people who require support and they do not in any way lack in ability or competence.

"Our vision is also to do our bit. With over 3,000 students joining the system, we should support a few. This is also an opportunity to give back to society," he said.

Mahmood Sait, CEO, Urbaser Sumeet, said, "Education can transform lives and uplift entire families, and we are grateful to the college for giving these deserving students an opportunity to pursue their dreams."

GPF accounts statement put up on website

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The General Provident Fund Annual Accounts Statement for 2025-2026 in respect of All India Services officers borne on Tamil Nadu cadre, Tamil Nadu State Government Employees, Tamil Nadu Panchayat Union and Municipal Elementary and Middle School, High and Higher Secondary School Teachers and teaching and non-teaching staff of Chennai and Madurai Corporation schools has been uploaded on May 25, 2026 in the official website of the Office of the Principal Accountant General (Accounts and Entitlements), Tamil Nadu - <https://cag.gov.in/ae/tamilnadu/en>.

THE HINDU
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Residents of Neelankarai, Palavakkam stage protest against power disruption

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

After a section of residents in Palavakkam and Neelankarai staged a protest complaining about low voltage and power disruptions on Monday night, senior officials of the Tamil Nadu Power Distribution Corporation Limited (TNPDC) pacified the crowd and installed an additional transformer on Tuesday.

M. Santosh, a resident of Pandian Street in Palavakkam, said the residential area has been experiencing power fluctuations in the day time as well as the night.

A senior official of the electricity department said the power disruption in a pocket of the locality was caused by the overloading of the distribution transformer installed on Pandian Street of the Neelankarai Link Road. However, to prevent the frequent tripping of the transformer, a new transformer was installed on Tuesday, the official added.

As the city's residents have been facing severe heat conditions, peak power demand touched an all-time high of 4,852

megawatts (MW) on May 22, and has been crossing 4,650 MW a day for the past few days, said a senior official of the electricity department.

However, the peak demand in the State has not even touched 19,000 MW. The rising temperature in the city in the past week has resulted in high power demand, leading to disruptions in several parts of the city, including Royapettah, T. Nagar and Alwarpet.

Ameer Hamsa, a resident of Dr. Besant Road in Royapettah, said the residents experienced power disruption for more than an hour on May 22 last week.

The official said that Electricity Minister R. Nirmal Kumar has been reviewing the city distribution network on a daily basis. In case of any lag in rectifying power disruptions, strict action would be taken, the official added.

Peak power demand in the city on Monday stood at 4,684 MW. The last time the city reached the highest peak demand was 4,769 MW on May 31, 2024. In 2025 the peak demand did not cross 4,600 MW, the official added.

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PERSONAL
CHANGE OF NAME
I, S.MONISHA (Old Name) Daughter of Thiru K M Sheriff, Date of birth 03 JUNE 1995 (Native District Sivagangai) Residing at No: 18-B, Thennmozhi Illam, Chinnathoppu Street, Madurai Road, Thirupattur, Sivagangai - 630211 Shall henceforth be known as NAZIRA BANU (New Name).

I, M. Mohamed Thanzeel, son of Thiru R. Musthafa, born on 28th January 1999 (Native District: Chennai), residing at No. 41/1, Indira Nagar, Pattur, Mangadu, Chennai-600 122, shall henceforth be known as M. MUHAMMAD MUZAMMIL - M. Mohamed Thanzeel

I, NIKITA Gracelyn Rose Rose d/o Jeyanth Suresh Rose born on 12/10/2007 residing at 43, N.K Nagar Bagayam Vellore Tamilnadu, have changed my name to Nikita Gracelyn Rose vide affidavit dated 22/05/2026 at Vellore.

I, RAMANILM, W/o. Harikrishnan B. Born on 28.11.1988, residing at No.1, Aravindh Nagar, 1st Main Road, Madambakkam Village, Madambakkam, Near Aravindh Nagar Park, Chennai-60012. I have changed my name Ramanil.M, vide affidavit dated 20th May 2026 at Chennai-126.

I, S. ABISHEK son of SEKAR residing at No. 21/9, Subramania Nagar, 1st Street, Kodambakkam, Chennai, Tamil Nadu - 600024; have changed the name of my minor daughter PRAGNYA ABISHEK aged 2 years, and she shall henceforth be known as ANVI ABISHEK

I, JEEVA S. D/O. SAMU K aged 27 years and born on 10-04-1999, at Thennupattur, Vellore, Tamilnadu and resident of No.3046, Appaswamy Splendour, Rajiv Gandhi Salai, OMFR, Semmanjeri, P.O., Sholinganallur, Chennai - 600119, Changed my name as JANVI VAIDYA SAMU. I shall henceforth be known as JANVI VAIDYA SAMU.

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WANTED @ Redhills Need MD (PMR), MBBS (DMO) Dentist.B.Sc(PA), OT Tech, MBA (Hosp Mgt) Accountant Insurance handling, Pharmacist, Staff nurse, House Keeping, Available ANM Nursing, Lab tech Pharmacy Courses. 9500091918 / 7200140077

GENERAL
REQUIRED 3 Candidates Tele-Marketing/ Accountant/ Sales Executive. Male/ Female Working Exp:2 Years, preferred Languages - Tamil, English & Hindi- Fluently. Contact-SRK International (Trust Of Steel) -9444000533/ 7418044453 -Anna Nagar,Ch-40 & Saravanampatty,Coimbatore-35. www.srkinternational.co.in

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Five persons
arrested for
vandalising
parked cars

CHENNAI: The Kodungaiyur Police arrested five persons for vandalising cars and auto-rickshaws parked on a street in Kodungaiyur. The arrested were identified as Veeramani, 28, Jayaprakash, 29, Jegan, 29, and two others – all residents of Kodungaiyur.

☀️ Timings
CHENNAI

WEDNESDAY, MAY. 27

☀️ RISE 05:42 SET 18:31
🌙 RISE 15:18 SET 02:35

THURSDAY, MAY. 28

☀️ RISE 05:42 SET 18:31
🌙 RISE 16:07 SET 03:13

FRIDAY, MAY. 29

☀️ RISE 05:42 SET 18:31
🌙 RISE 16:57 SET 03:52

Chennai Weather	max	min
Tiruvallur	41	26
Chennai Airport	41	29
Chennai City	39	30

Chennai Airport Today
39°C Day will be very hot and uneasy. Night will also be uneasy. Chances of light rain and thundershowers.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
38°C The weather will be dry. Day will be slightly hot and uneasy with moderate winds. Night will remain uneasy.

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Pulicat sanctuary boundary must
be redrawn within a year: NBWL

Chief Wildlife Warden informed the committee that the draft ESZ notification had already been submitted to the Union Environment Ministry and assured members that the process would be completed within next year

ECO WATCH

Geetha Srimathi
CHENNAI

The Standing Committee of the National Board for Wildlife (SC-NBWL) has directed the Tamil Nadu government to complete the rationalisation of the boundaries of the Pulicat Lake Bird Sanctuary within a year, while clearing two industrial expansion projects near the protected wetland in Tiruvallur district. The direction came during the 87th meeting of the SC-NBWL, where the committee discussed concerns over the current delineation of the sanctuary boundary and the long-pending notification of the Eco-Sensitive Zone (ESZ). According to the mi-



Call for conservation: The committee discussed concerns over the current delineation and the long-pending notification of the Eco-Sensitive Zone. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

nutes of the meeting, ecologist Raman Sukumar observed that the sanctuary boundary appeared to have been “incorrectly delineated” and should largely be confined to the lagoon area of Pulicat Lake, which forms the primary habitat for flamingos and other key avifaunal species. The present boundary, he noted, includes ad-

joining villages that support only common bird species. In 2024, the Tamil Nadu government initiated the process of settling claims in these villages as part of steps towards issuing the final notification for the sanctuary under the Wildlife (Protection) Act. Environmentalists had then warned that

excluding villages from the notified sanctuary boundary could significantly shrink the default ESZ area. The projects had earlier been deferred in March 2025 pending a scientific assessment by the National Centre for Sustainable Coastal Management (NCSCM). The study later concluded that the ‘zone of influence’ around the sanctuary extended only up to 5.1 km, and that both projects, located within SIPCOT and over 5.5 km away, were unlikely to affect wildlife. The Tamil Nadu Chief Wildlife Warden informed the committee that the draft ESZ notification had already been submitted to the Union Environment Ministry and assured members that the process of rationalising the Pulicat boundary would be completed within next year.

trial expansion projects located 8.5 km and 7.87 km respectively from the sanctuary, within the default ESZ area. The projects had earlier been deferred in March 2025 pending a scientific assessment by the National Centre for Sustainable Coastal Management (NCSCM). The study later concluded that the ‘zone of influence’ around the sanctuary extended only up to 5.1 km, and that both projects, located within SIPCOT and over 5.5 km away, were unlikely to affect wildlife. The Tamil Nadu Chief Wildlife Warden informed the committee that the draft ESZ notification had already been submitted to the Union Environment Ministry and assured members that the process of rationalising the Pulicat boundary would be completed within next year.

APPOINTMENT

NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY CALICUT
NIT Campus P.O., Calicut, Kerala – 673601, India

Applications are invited for filling up the following Group A posts on direct recruitment / deputation including short term contract basis in NIT Calicut. Details of the posts are as under:-

Sl. No.	Name of the post	Number of vacancy	Pay level in the Pay Matrix	Mode of recruitment
1.	Registrar	1	Level-14	Deputation (ISTC)
2.	Deputy Registrar	2	Level-12	Direct Recruitment
3.	Technical Officer	4	Level-10	Direct Recruitment
4.	Executive Engineer (Civil)	1	Level-10	Direct Recruitment
5.	Medical Officer	1	Level-10	Direct Recruitment

The eligibility conditions may be downloaded from the NITC website www.nitc.ac.in.

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Raja Annamalai Building Rukmani Lakshminipathi Road, Egmore Chennai 600008	2 Units	86 m ² – 232 m ² (924 sf – 2,500 sf)
Big Bell Building Prospect Lodge, Havelock Road, R.S. Puram Coimbatore 641002	1 Unit	44 m ² (475 sf)
Plot of Land Prospect Lodge, Havelock Road, Ootacamund Town Ootacamund Taluk, Udagamandalam, The Nilgiris 643001	Land	1,403 m ² (15,106 sf)

Last date for bid submission
Friday
26th June 2026

For site visits & more details, please contact
indarpal.kalra@anarock.com
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"CA / CMA qualified candidates are highly encouraged to apply"

State Bank of India
Central Recruitment & Promotion Department
Corporate Centre, Mumbai
Phone: 022-22820427; email: crpd@sbi.co.in

Engagement of Apprentices in SBI under Apprenticeship Act 1961 (Advertisement No. CRPD/APPR/2026-27/07)

Applications are invited from Indian citizens for Engagement of Apprentices in State Bank of India.

Number of Apprentices: 7150
Training Period: One year

(CARE: This is a training opportunity under Apprenticeship Act 1961 and not an offer of Employment.)

Eligibility criteria (age, educational qualification, fees, etc.) and other details are available under Advertisement No. CRPD/APPR/2026-27/07 on Bank's website <https://sbi.bank.in/web/careers/current-openings> OR <https://apprenticeshipindia.org> OR <https://nsdcindia.org/apprenticeship> OR <http://bfsissc.com> along with a link for online submission of application.

Candidates are advised to go through the detailed advertisement ensuring their eligibility and other details before applying and remitting fees.

• DATE FOR FILLING ONLINE APPLICATION: 19.05.2026 to 08.06.2026

For any query, please write to us through link **"CONTACT US"** → **"Post Your Query"** which is available on Bank's website URL - <https://sbi.bank.in/careers/post-your-query>

Place: Mumbai
Date: 19.05.2026
General Manager (RP&PM)

ALVA'S Institute of Engineering & Technology (Autonomous)
Mijar, Moodubidire - 574 225, D.K., Karnataka

REQUIRED FACULTY FOR
CSE | AIML | ISE | CSD | DATA SCIENCE
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MATHEMATICS | AGRICULTURE ENGG.
MECHANICAL ENGG.

• PROFESSORS
• ASSOCIATE PROFESSORS
• ASSISTANT PROFESSORS

Qualification: As per AICTE Norms
Pay Scale: Salary as per 7th Pay Commission
Candidates should possess good academic background and communication skill

Last Date to Apply: Within 7 days from the date of this Advertisement
Interested candidates may send their resume to:
principalaiet08@gmail.com
Ph: 94484 58334, 63602 56724

The Lawrence School
Lovedale, Ooty - 643 003, The Nilgiris (TN)
Phone : 0423 2453338, 2442552
Website : www.thelawrenceschool.org

Applications are invited from well-qualified and experienced personnel for the following posts.

1. Catering Manager Any Degree + 1-year Diploma in Catering Management from a recognized university (OR) Degree / 3-year Diploma in Catering Management from a recognized university (OR) Officer/JCO rank with Catering Management experience in Category 'A' Armed Forces establishments (IMA, NDA, OTA, INA or AFA). With minimum of 10 years of experience, preferably in an Educational Institution.

2. Teachers in Tamil, Telugu, Malayalam & Kanada (Fixed Term Contract) - Postgraduate in the concerned subject with a B.Ed degree from a recognized university and a minimum of 2 years of experience in handling secondary classes in CBSE schools.

3. English Teacher Postgraduate in English with a B.Ed. degree from a recognized university and a minimum of 3 years of experience.

4. Archery Coach (Fixed Term Contract)- Well qualified and experienced personnel.

Suitable candidates may send their resume along with testimonials and a recent photograph to resume@thelawrenceschool.org, clearly mentioning the post applied for within 10 days. Only shortlisted candidates will be called for interview. The school offers competitive remuneration along with other perks.

HEADMASTER

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ACADEMIC LEADERSHIP POSITIONS

DEANS for the following Schools
Mysuru: Pure & Applied Sciences, Psychology & Behavioural Sciences, Allied & Healthcare Professions (Proposed)
Bengaluru: School of Education (Proposed)

Eligibility: Ph.D. in the relevant field: Pure/ Applied Sciences, Psychology, Allied Health Sciences, Education with a minimum of 15 years of teaching/research experience, of which at least 3 years should be at the level of professor or equivalent. Proven academic leadership and research excellence required.

FACULTY POSITIONS

Professor/ Associate Professor/ Assistant Professor for the following Schools
Business (BLR), Law (BLR), Computer Science & Engineering (BLR), Management (MYS)

Eligibility: Ph.D. in relevant field: Business/Management, Law, Computer Science, with strong academic record and research publications.

ADMINISTRATIVE POSITIONS

Assistant/ Deputy Registrar (Legal)
Eligibility: LLB/LLM with minimum 8–10 years of experience in legal matters, preferably in higher education institutions. Strong knowledge of UGC, AICTE regulations and university governance is essential.

Director – International Relations
Eligibility: Master's degree with 8–12 years of experience in international collaborations, MoUs, student exchange and global partnerships. Experience in higher education sector is highly desirable.

Director – Corporate Relations
Eligibility: Master's degree with 12–15 years of experience in building strong partnerships with Corporates, MNCs and PSUs, driving campus placements, internships, research collaborations and enhancing industry engagement.

Interested candidates may log on to
<https://rvu.edu.in/careers> to apply

GENERAL

AMET UNIVERSITY
Deemed to be University

RECRUITMENT FOR THE POST OF VICE CHANCELLOR

The Search cum Selection Committee invites applications from the eligible candidates, as per UGC norms, for the post of **Vice Chancellor**, AMET Deemed to be University. Interested and eligible candidates shall apply with detailed bio-data including documents in support of accomplishments. The self-attested scanned version of the application along with the details shall be sent to vcsearchcommittee@ametuniv.ac.in or hard copy may sent by post to The Chairman, Search cum Selection Committee, C/o. The Registrar (Nodal Officer) AMET Deemed to be University, 135, East Coast Road, Kanathur, Chennai 603112 within 15 days from the date of this advertisement.

- Registrar i/c

THE SOUTH INDIA TEXTILE RESEARCH ASSOCIATION
Post box No.3205, 13/37, Avinashi Road, Coimbatore – 641 014
Phone (0422) 4251333, 2574367-9

Invites applications from prospective candidates for the post of **Administrative Officer**

Must possess a minimum of a Master's Degree (full-time), preferably an MBA, with a minimum of 20 years of experience, including at least the last 5 years in a senior position.
Age: Above 40 years.

Interested candidates may send their detailed Bio-data with recent passport size photograph immediately to skr@sitra.org.in / hr@sitra.org.in within 10 days.
Please visit our website www.sitra.org.in for detailed job description.

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JOB VACANCIES 2026

PHARMEXCIL Invites Applications for the following Positions.

1. SENIOR DIRECTOR (POLICY & LIAISON)
Location: Mumbai, India (Reports to DG)
Key Role: Government liaison (DGFT, Customs, Ministry of Commerce), Industry representations, Drafting Policy Papers
Qualifications: PG in Economics, International Trade, MBA or Law.
Experience: 15-20 years in the Pharma Industry with expertise in EXIM matters, Foreign Trade Policy, and WTO frameworks.

1. सीनियर डायरेक्टर (पॉलिसी एंड लिएजोन)
/ वरिष्ठ निदेशक (नीति और संपर्क)
स्थान: मुंबई, भारत (महानिदेशक को रिपोर्ट करना होगा)
मुख्य भूमिका: सरकारी संपर्क, सीमा शुल्क [वाणिज्य मंत्रालय], उद्योग प्रतिनिधित्व, नीति पत्र तैयार करना।
योग्यता: अर्थशास्त्र, अंतर्राष्ट्रीय व्यापार में सातकोत्तर, MBA या लॉ (कानून)।
अनुभव: फार्मा उद्योग में 15-20 वर्ष का अनुभव, साथ ही मामलों, विदेश व्यापार नीति और के ढांचे में विशेषज्ञता।

2. COMPANY SECRETARY (On Consultancy)
Location: Hyderabad, India (Reports to DG)
Key Role: Corporate Governance, Statutory / Regulatory Compliance under the Companies Act, Managing Board / AGM meetings, and RoC filings.
Qualifications: Member of the Institute of Company Secretaries of India (ICSI).
Experience: Min.15 years of Post-qualification experience. EPC or PSU experience preferred.

2. कंपनी सेक्रेटरी (परामर्श पर) / कंपनी सचिव (कंसल्टेंसी पर)
स्थान: हैदराबाद, भारत (महानिदेशक को रिपोर्ट करना होगा)
मुख्य भूमिका: कॉर्पोरेट गवर्नेंस, कंपनी अधिनियम के तहत वैधानिक/नियामक अनुपालन, बोर्ड / एजीएम (AGM) बैठकों का प्रबंधन, और फाइलिंग।
योग्यता: इंस्टीट्यूट ऑफ कंपनी सेक्रेटरीज ऑफ इंडिया (ICSI) के सदस्य।
अनुभव: योग्यता प्राप्ति के बाद का न्यूनतम 15 वर्ष का अनुभव। EPC या PSU के अनुभव को वरीयता दी जाएगी।

Send your detailed resume and Supporting Documents to hr@pharmexcil.com on or before 6 June 2026

A CH-CHE

**WEST CENTRAL RAILWAY**

OPEN TENDER
NIT No.: JBP/LC/T/2026/02
The Deputy Chief Electrical Engineer (Construction), West Central Railway, Jabalpur for and on behalf of President of India invites E-Tenders from the reputed and experienced contractors having valid 'A' class Electrical License (in the name of Firm or with one of the partner or in his own name is vele proprietor) issued by any state Govt. through ON-Line for the following works. Manual offers are not allowed against this tender, and any such manual offer received shall be ignored. **NIT No. : JBP/LC/T/2026/02** dt: 22.05.2026, **Name of work with location :** Design, supply, erection, testing, and commissioning of 2x25 KV, AC 50 Hz OHE electrification system in Baraklera (Excl.) to Ajaygarh (Incl.) section in Khajuraho Panna new BG Rail line section of Jabalpur division, West Central Railway, Jabalpur in connection with Lalitpur Singrauli new BG Rail Line project. **Approx. cost of the work (in Rs.) :** Rs 24,16,84,587.18, **Cost of tender form :** nil, **Address of the office:** Deputy Chief Electrical Engineer (Construction)/Jabalpur, C- floor, CPM-Project office building, Opposite MP Tourism office, JBP-482001., **Bid Security (in Rs.) :** Rs 48,33,700.00, **Completion period :** 18 months, **Date & Time for submission of tender :** 15.06.2026 (Up to 15.00 hrs.), **Data & Time for opening of tender :** 15.06.2026 (at 15:30 hrs.) Complete details of tender document available on the Railway website <https://ireps.gov.in> and also placed on notice boards of Deputy Chief Electrical Engines (Construction), Jabalpur.
Sd/-
Deputy Chief Electrical Engineer (Con.), West Central Railway, Jabalpur

**सख्त भारत अभियान**
एक कदम स्वच्छता की ओर

CENTRAL RAILWAY
SIGNALING WORK
Divisional Railway Manager (S&T), 1st Floor, Parcel Office Building, above P.F.No.14 & 15, Central Railway, Mumbai CST 400 001, for and on behalf of the President of India invites Open tenders from the reputed contractors. **S.N.:- 1. Name of work:-** Signaling work in connection with Provision of additional loop lines on UP side in Jite Station of Mumbai division. **TENDER NOTICE NO. CR/BB/ SNT/East/2026/26, Approximate Cost:-** Rs.4.20/-CRORE, **EMD:-** Rs 841600/-, **Date of Opening:-** 22.06.2026, **Validity:-** 60 days, **Completion Period:-** 12 Months, This tender complies with Public Procurement Policy (Make in India) Order 2017, dated 15/06/2017. Complete details of tenders are available at Central Railway. Official website www.ireps.gov.in the complete tender documents can be downloaded from the website. The complete details of tenders are also available in the "Notice Board" of the Divisional Railway Manager (S&T)'s Office, Mumbai CST. **186**
Keep your animals away from railway lines

CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE
Tender notice No CWE/MTN/ 85265868/2026 due on 01-JUL-26
Sr No: 1, Tender No: 85265868, Tender Title: (For Vande Bharat) Reaction Rod assembly to Medha Component Number SPTS5A013207R0001, Qty: 70 Nos., Due date: 01-JUL-26, Value: 18055264, 193
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CORRIGENDUM NO. 01 AGAINST TENDER NOTICE NO.: CON/2026/MAY/04; DATED: 20-05-2026
Corrigendum-01 for Tender No. CE-CON-FT-PMS-2026-03RT1 has been published. For details please visit www.ireps.gov.in
Chief Engineer/Con/ Lumding Project, Maligaon NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY (Construction Organisation) "SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE"

**KARNATAKA POWER CORPORATION LIMITED**
CIN : U05110KA1970SGC001919
No:KPCL/2025-26/EL/WORK_INDENT4052/Call-2 Date: 26.05.2026
ABSTRACT TENDER NOTIFICATION (Through e-Procurement Portal only) (Two Cover System)
KPCL invites sealed bids in English through GoK e-procurement platform <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> from the qualified bidders for Design, Manufacture, Testing, Supply and Commissioning of 8 Nos. of Online Partial Discharge Monitoring System (PDMS) for Generators of RTPS Project conforming to KPCL, Technical Specification. Last date for receipt completed bids: 12.06.2026 at 17.00 hrs. Further details can be had from Chief Engineer (Thermal Designs), KPCL, No.3, (Green Building), 2nd Floor, Behind Drug Controller Office Premises, Palace Road, Bengaluru-560 001. Mobile No:9972488569/9449596527 [Exe.Engr Ele-3] e-mail: kpclcetd@gmail.com / cetdkpcl@karnataka.gov.in

CENTRAL RAILWAY
Corrigendum No.1
Tender No.1) 51.26.6090 Dept/Rly. STORES/CENTRAL RAILWAY Closing: 29.05.2026 11:30 am
Tender Title- Manufacturing/ Fabrication and supply of 1 in 8.5 Diamond Crossing T-6493 & T-6494 NIT Header

Field Name	Tender No.	Existing Qty	Modified Qty
Tender opening Date/Time	51.26.6090	13 Sets	1)T-6493-13 Sets 2)T-6494-25 Sets.

192
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EMPANELMENT OF ADVERTISING AGENCIES FOR SOUTH EASTERN RAILWAY
Applications are invited from INS Accredited Advertising Agencies for empanelment in South Eastern Railway for Public Relations advertising related activities and allied works. The application form can be downloaded from the website www.ser.indianrailways.gov.in (Department → Public Relations → EMPANELMENT OF ADVERTISING AGENCIES OF SOUTH EASTERN RAILWAY) from 27th May, 2026 to 17th June, 2026. All other relevant details and eligibility criteria are also available in the aforesaid website.
The cost of the application form is Rs. 5,900/- (non-refundable) (Rs. 5,000/- + 18% GST Rs. 900/-) to be paid by Demand Draft, drawn in favour of "FA & CAO, South Eastern Railway" payable at Kolkata. Or it may also be paid in cash, which is to be deposited to the Chief Cashier, South Eastern Railway, Garden Reach and the money receipt for the same be obtained.
Demand Draft/Money receipt for the cost of the application form is to be submitted separately at the time of submission of the application. The duly filled in application form including all relevant self-attested documents are to be dropped/submitted in a Sealed Envelope in a box kept at the Office of the Chief Public Relations Officer, 11, Garden Reach Road, Kolkata-700043, available on all working days from 10:30 hrs. to 18:00 hrs. from 27th May, 2026 to 15:00 hrs. of 17th June, 2026. The date and time of opening of application forms are 16:00 hrs. of 17th June, 2026.
No application will be entertained after the date and time specified above.
Chief Public Relations Officer
**South Eastern Railway (PR-236)**
We serve with a smile

SOUTHERN RAILWAY
Tiruchirappalli Division
E Tender Notice No. TPJ/09 of 2026 Dt. 25.05.2026
Divisional Railway Manager / Works Branch / Tiruchirappalli Division, Tiruchirappalli-1 for and on behalf of the President of India invites ONLINE tenders for the following works as per tender notice and Complete details are given in our e-tender portal www.ireps.gov.in

Sl. No	Tender No.	Name of Work	Approx. Value of Work (Rs. in Lakhs)	Amount of EMD (in Rs.)	Completion Period of Work
1	TPJ-09-2026-01	Annual maintenance of high roof structures at various shops in Central Workshop/GOC for the period of one year.	112.07	224100	12 months
2	TPJ-09-2026-02	Finishing works at OPD block in Ground Floor and Foyer at Railway Hospital/ GOC.	171.87	343700	5 months
3	TPJ-09-2026-03	Earthwork in forming embankment, construction of track machine office building, store shed, CC flooring, approach road etc., in connection with Provision of shunting neck stabling lines between GOC and TPJ stations.	374.33	748700	9 months
4	TPJ-09-2026-04	Construction of overhead tank of 1.0 Lakh litres capacity and Ground level reservoir of 2.50 lakh litres capacity. Provision of bore well and pipe line arrangements in connection with provision of shunting neck and stabling line between GOC and TPJ stations.	150.76	301500	9 months
5	TPJ-09-2026-05	Construction of Running room 18 beds capacity in ground floor at TVR station.	215.26	430500	9 months
6	TPJ-09-2026-06	Track Maintenance works in SSE/P.Way/TJ section for a period of one year.	102.02	204000	12 months
7	TPJ-09-2026-07	(i) Construction of Running room 18 beds capacity in ground floor at VLNK station and (ii) Improvement works to the existing carriage watering hydrant line and side drain between Road 1 and 2 at MQ station.	229.59	459200	9 months
8	TPJ-09-2026-08	Track Maintenance works in SSE/P.Way/CUPJ section for a period of one year.	115.50	231000	12 months
9	TPJ-09-2026-09	Track Maintenance works in SSE/P.Way/B-TVR section for a period of one year.	77.67	155400	12 months
10	TPJ-09-2026-10	Track Maintenance works in SSE/P.Way/B-VRI section for a period of one year.	70.10	140200	12 months
11	TPJ-09-2026-11	Track Maintenance works in SSE/P.Way/PKT section for a period of one year.	81.60	163200	12 months
12	TPJ-09-2026-12	Track Maintenance works in SSE/P.Way/TTP section for a period of one year.	109.93	219900	12 months

SI. No. 1-6: Tender closing date and time: 17.06.2026 at 15.00 Hrs
SI. No. 7-12: Tender closing date and time: 22.06.2026 at 15.00 Hrs
Note: (i) It is the responsibility of the tenderer to check any Corrigendum issued for any correction or modifications uploaded subsequently in website, the same shall be taken into account while submitting tender.
(ii) Exemption from remitting Bid Security Amount (EMD):
The following categories of tenderers are only exempted from remitting Bid Security:
a) Any firm recognized by Department of Industrial Policy and Promotion (DIPP) as 'Startups' shall be exempted from payment of Bid Security.
b) Labour Co-operative Societies shall submit only 50% of Bid Security.
Tenderer should submit relevant documents along with his/her offer from remitting Bid Security. Non-submission of relevant documents, shall lead to summary rejection of offer. Corrigendum to E-Tender Notice No. TPJ/08 of 2026 Dt.08.05.2026.
(i) Modified tender value & EMD amount:

Sl. No	Tender No.	Value of the work (Rs. in Lakhs)		Amount of EMD (in Rs.)	
		Existing	Read as	Existing	Read as
1	TPJ-08-2026-03	384.65	328.58	769300	657200
2	TPJ-08-2026-02	514.09	514.12	1028190	1028200
3	TPJ-08-2026-07	No change		989400	989500

The other terms and conditions remain unchanged.
Divisional Railway Manager / Works / Tiruchirappalli
For and on behalf of the President of India.

**Government of Odisha**
Sports & Youth Services Department
Kalinga Stadium, Nayapalli, Bhubaneswar-751012
e-mail : deptsportsodisha@gmail.com

Corrigendum
With reference to RFP No: PT3-SYS-YS-YS-0017-2026-16676/SYS dated 15.05.2026, modifications to the RFP have been issued vide Corrigendum No. PT3-SYS-YS-YS-0017-2026-17771/SYS dated 26.05.2026. These amendments shall be deemed an integral part of the original RFP.
All other terms and conditions stated in the original RFP remain unchanged. All applicants are requested to comply with the revised provisions.
For further details, please refer to the official notifications available on our websites : <https://sports.odisha.gov.in> and <https://tendersodisha.gov.in>.
Sd/-
Additional Secretary
29001/10/2627
CIPR-29001/29001/11/26-27/0008

GOVERNMENT OF JHARKHAND
OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
NATIONAL HIGHWAYS DIVISION, HAZARIBAGH
Request for Proposal for Performance based Maintenance Contracts.
NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Tender Reference No. - NH/HAZARIBAGH/2026-27/01 Dated: 26.05.2026
Application in the prescribed format form eligible contractors for Request for Proposal Performance based Maintenance Contracts (PBM) mode are invited for following project in two bid systems, (Technical & Financial)

Sl. No.	Name of Work	Length	Estimated Cost including LC and excluding GST (in Rs.)	Cost of RFP document (in Rs)	Bid Security (in Rs.)	Contract Duration (Month)
1	PBM work of NH-522 from Km 48.00 to 62.650 in the State of Jharkhand under National Highway Division, Hazaribagh for the year 2026-27	14.650 km	13,25,75,295/-	10,000/- (RFP) & 1,800/- (GST)	13,26,000/-	60

Note – GST amount will be paid as per Government Norms applicable from time to time.
Important Dates

1. Date of Issue of Notice Inviting RFP	26.05.2026
2. Last Date For Receiving Queries	21.06.2026 at 17:00 Hrs
3. Pre-BID Meeting at Venue (as mentioned in RFP)	22.06.2026 at 12:30 Hrs
4. Authority Response to Queries Latest by	29.06.2026
5. Period of Sale of Bid Document	From 29.05.2026 17:00 Hrs to 13.07.2026 upto 17:00 Hrs through official portal of : [https://eprocure.gov.in]
6. BID Due Date	Date 13.07.2026 upto 17:00 Hrs through official portal of : [https://eprocure.gov.in]
7. Last date of physical submission of bid security, POA and other documents in original	14.07.2026, up to 12.30 Hrs
8. Time and Date of Opening Technical Bid (RFP)	Date 14.07.2026 17:00 Hrs through official portal of: [https://eprocure.gov.in]
9. Time and Date Opening Financial Bid	To be notify. Through official portal of : [https://eprocure.gov.in]
10. Place of Opening of Bids	Office of the Chief Engineer, NH Wing, Jharkhand, Ranchi Through official portal of: [https://eprocure.gov.in]
11. Bid Validity	120 Days from the Bid Due Date.
12. Officer Inviting Bids	Executive Engineer NH Division, Hazaribagh

Executive Engineer
NH Division, Hazaribagh
PR 380812 Road (26-27)_D

**KARNATAKA STATE ROAD TRANSPORT CORPORATION**
Central Offices, Stores and Purchase Dept, K.H. Road, Shanthinagar, Bengaluru-560 027

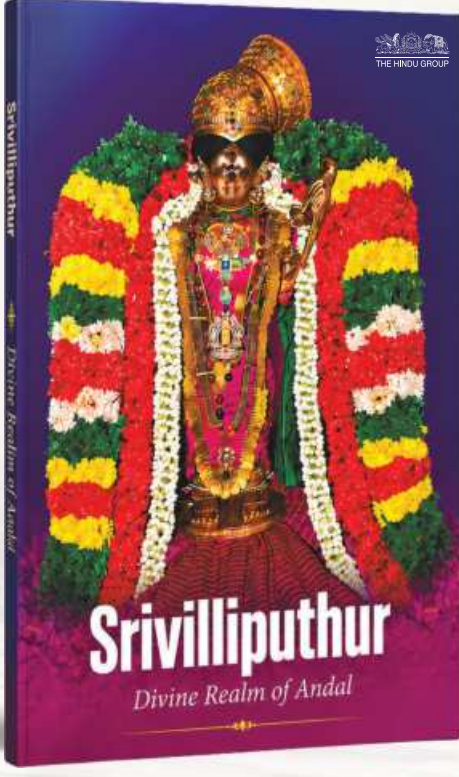
NOTICE INVITING TENDER NO 2 Dated:25.05.2026
Tenders (Pre-qualification and or (Commercial offers) through e-procurement portal are invited for supply of the following Goods/ Services.

Tender Nos. as per E-portal	Nomenclature of Items/ Services/ Equipment	Tender Value in Crores Rs. (Approx)	Last date for submission of tender @17.00 Hrs
KSRTC/2026-27/IND0294	Procurement of Automotive lubricants required for Tata & Ashok Leyland BS-VI Vehicle	1.22	26/05/2026
KSRTC/2026-27/IND0295	Procurement of Fire Detection and Suppression System- FDSS as per AIS 135 KSRTC Buses	1.12	01/06/2026
KSRTC/2026-27/IND0296	Procurement of 2K PU Paints and Allied Materials	8.00	08/06/2026
KSRTC/2026-27/IND0297	Procurement of Print & Cut Eco Solvent Inkjet Flex Printer, lamination Machine & personal Computer	0.20	01/06/2026
KSRTC/2026-27/IND0299	Procurement of Oil Seals	1.80	20/06/2026
KSRTC/2026-27/IND0300	Procurement of PU Adhesive Sealant	1.50	22/06/2026
KSRTC/2026-27/IND0301	Procurement of Fan Belts	0.70	22/06/2026
KSRTC/2026-27/IND0302	Procurement of Water pump and parts	3.84	22/06/2026
KSRTC/2026-27/IND0303	Procurement of Fastners	1.00	22/06/2026

NOTE:- Interested suppliers need to register in the e-procurement portal. For further information log into <http://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> In case of further assistance, contact e-procurement cell (Phone. No. 080-46010000/080-68948777). Interested bidders may also contact e-procurement cell for training on bid submission. Mail to support@eproc.helppdesk.com for further information if required. In case of bidders need assistance from KSRTC, can communicate at cosp@ksrtc.org, (contact: 7760990224)
Sd/-
Controller of Stores & Purchases (Tender Inviting Authority)
DIPR/CP/JA/811/2026-27

**THE HINDU GROUP**

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E-mail-jfi@jharkhandaviation.in, Website-www.jharkhandaviation.in

Ref. No.: JFI / Employment-25/2025-429 /Ranchi, Dated:-23.05.2026
Notice
Jharkhand Flying Institute (JFI) invites application from qualified and experienced candidates for Technical/ Non-Technical Post for FTO.
Please visit our website:-www.jharkhandaviation.in and submit the resume to e-mail:-employment.jfi@gmail.com. Last date of receipt of application is-10.06.2026
Sd/-
(Managing Director)
Jharkhand Flying Institute
PR 380667 (Civil Aviation)26-27'D

**Govt. of Bihar**

**Bihar Medical Services & Infrastructure Corporation Limited**
2nd & 3rd Floor, Swasthya Bhawan, Behind IGIMS, Sheikhpura, Adjacent to State Health Society, Bihar, Patna- 800014
Phone/Fax: +919006405255, +91 9471009193

TENDER NOTICE
Tender for rate contract and supply of Drugs for different healthcare facilities of state of Bihar
Notice Inviting Tender Ref No.: -BMSIC/DRUGS/26-04
(Only through E- Tender on website:- www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
Bihar Medical Services and Infrastructure Corporation Limited (BMSICL) invites E-Bids from the interested parties for "Tender for rate contract and supply of Drugs for different healthcare facilities of state of Bihar", vide Notice Inviting Tender No.- BMSIC/DRUGS/26-04. Detailed tender document containing eligibility criteria, selection mechanism, other terms and conditions are available on the website www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in.

Tender Schedule

Tender Reference No.	BMSIC/DRUGS/26-04
Date of Pre-Bid meeting	03 rd June 2026 at 02:30 P.M. at BMSICL Conference Hall, 3 rd Floor, Swasthya Bhawan, Behind IGIMS, Sheikhpura, Adjacent to State Health Society, Bihar, Patna- 800014
Last date and time of submission of online bids	23 rd June 2026 by 05:00 P.M.
Last date and time for submission of EMD and Tender Fees	25 th June 2026 till 02:00 P.M.
Date, Time and Place of opening of Technical Bid	25 th June 2026 (at 03:00 P.M.) on the website of www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in in the office of BMSICL
Date and time of opening of Financial Bids	To be announced later on www.bmsicl.gov.in and www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
Validity of Tender	180 Days
Cost of the tender document	Rs. 11,800/- (Eleven Thousand Eight Hundred only) Non-refundable.

GM (Procurement) BMSICL
For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar
PR. No. 004275 (B&C) 2026-27
नशामुक्त हो जाए बिहार, सुरक्षित रहे घर परिवार।

CM
YK



D.K. Shivakumar hailed the SC decision and said that Karnataka is in the process of submitting the revised DPR. SUDHAKARA JAIN

SC rejects review plea by Tamil Nadu on Mekedatu project

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court has dismissed a petition filed by Tamil Nadu to review a November 2025 decision that termed the State's challenge to Karnataka's proposed Mekedatu Balancing Reservoir cum Drinking Water project as "premature".

The review petition was dismissed by the Bench via circulation in their chambers on April 15, 2026. The order was only published recently.

"We have carefully gone through the contents of the review petition and the papers appended therewith. We are satisfied that no case for review of the judgment dated November 13, 2025 is made out. The review petition is, accordingly, dismissed," the short order said.

On November 13, 2025 the court had said the Detailed Project Report (DPR) on the reservoir, submitted by Karnataka, was only being considered by the experts in the Cauvery Water

Management Authority (CWMA) and Cauvery Water Regulation Committee (CWRC).

The court had said that in case of approval of DPR, the affected parties, including Tamil Nadu, would be free to take measures in accordance with the law. But for now, it was too early, the court had concluded. The apex court had said, Karnataka, anyway, would be bound to release Cauvery water allotted to lower riparian Tamil Nadu and Puducherry, which was downstream.

'Good news for us'
Karnataka Deputy Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar who also holds Water Resources portfolio, hailed the court's judgment. "We are in the process of submitting the revised Detailed Project Report. This is good news for Karnataka. On behalf of the people of Karnataka, we express our gratitude to the Supreme Court," Mr. Shivakumar told presspersons in New Delhi on Tuesday.

In sign of change, Congress offers Siddaramaiah RS seat

Leadership change appears imminent in Karnataka; Siddaramaiah likely to announce his decision tomorrow; Venugopal says the meeting discussed RS candidates and Legislative Council elections

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU/NEW DELHI

Leadership change in Karnataka appeared imminent, after it emerged on Tuesday that the Congress high command has offered Karnataka Chief Minister Siddaramaiah a seat in the Rajya Sabha as a candidate in the forthcoming elections.

Whether or not Mr. Siddaramaiah agrees to be a candidate for the June 18 Rajya Sabha polls, sources close to him indicated that he is likely to announce his decision on Thursday. His deputy D.K. Shivakumar has been an aspirant for the post ever since the Congress government



The Congress appears undecided on the Karnataka Cabinet reshuffle, and a new KPCC chief. ANI

reached half-year-mark in November 2025. However, Mr. Siddaramaiah need not resign immediately, sources said.

Officially, party general secretary (organisation) K.C. Venugopal said the

day-long deliberations were only about selecting candidates for the Rajya Sabha and Karnataka Legislative Council elections, and dismissed the question of leadership change at a press briefing.

Sources said that the Congress high command cannot push through a leadership change if Mr. Siddaramaiah, a prominent OBC face, does not agree. That is why the party officially downplayed any talk of leadership change, sources added. Mr. Siddaramaiah is currently the only OBC Chief Minister among the four Congress-ruled States.

A senior party functionary said the Congress high command appeared unable to arrive at a final decision on three key issues - leadership change, Cabinet reshuffle, and the appointment of a new Karnataka Pradesh Congress Committee (KPCC) president.

Kerala HC clears ED probe in CMRL case

The Hindu Bureau
KOCHI

The Kerala High Court on Tuesday gave the go-ahead to the Enforcement Directorate (ED) to probe the alleged financial transactions between Exalogic Solutions, a firm owned by former Kerala Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan's daughter T. Veena, and the Cochin Minerals and Rutile Ltd (CMRL), in the alleged pay-off scam. The court further dismissed the

CMRL's plea to quash the case. It directed the firm's officials to appear before the ED and to cooperate with the probe.

The ED submitted before the court that its probe was independent of a probe by the SFIO (Serious Fraud Investigation Office) into the matter.

Ms. Veena had earlier submitted before the court that all financial transactions were conducted through legitimate electronic means.

5 of Pinarayi's security personnel suspended

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

The Kerala Police suspended five officers attached to the former Kerala Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan's personal security detail on Tuesday.

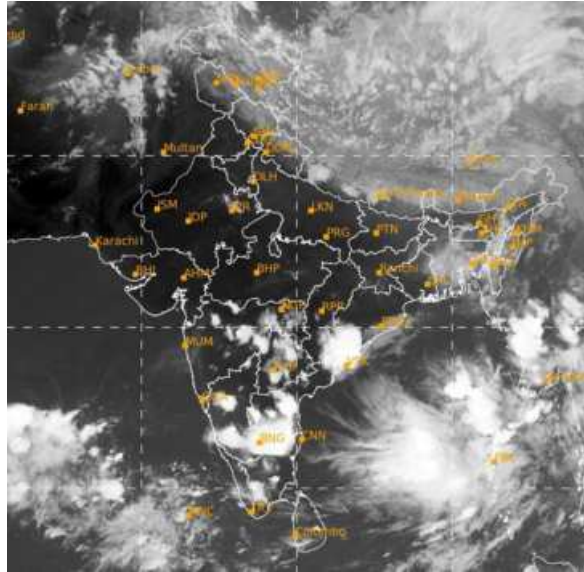
A Special Investigation Team (SIT) headed by the Crime Branch charged the officers with overstepping their line of official duty and unleashing wanton violence against the tiny group of Youth Congress

workers who were detained by the local law enforcement to prevent them from greeting Mr. Vijayan's Navakerala Sadas motorcade with black flags when it entered Alappuzha in Kerala in November 2023.

The prosecution's case is that the squad "unjustifiably" stepped out of their escort vehicle after the vehicle ferrying Mr. Vijayan had swept past the point, and caned the roadside protesters who were already in the custody.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 18.15 HRS)

Forecast for Wednesday: Heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Bihar, Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Meghalaya, Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram, Tripura, Sikkim, West Bengal and Karnataka. Heat wave to severe heat wave conditions likely at isolated places over Rajasthan, Punjab, Haryana, Delhi, Uttar Pradesh and Madhya Pradesh

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala.....	80.....	26.2.....	21.2.....	Kozhikode.....		34.6.....	27.2.....
Ahmedabad.....		43.2.....	28.2.....	Kurnool.....		40.0.....	29.1.....
Aizawl.....	11.....	26.4.....	17.2.....	Lucknow.....		42.9.....	28.3.....
Allahabad.....		45.4.....	29.4.....	Madurai.....		38.5.....	27.6.....
Bengaluru.....		33.2.....	22.6.....	Mangaluru.....		32.8.....	26.0.....
Bhopal.....		43.2.....	29.4.....	Mumbai.....		34.7.....	29.0.....
Bhubaneswar.....		39.2.....	29.7.....	Mysuru.....		33.2.....	21.4.....
Chandigarh.....		41.7.....	24.6.....	New Delhi.....		43.5.....	26.8.....
Chennai.....		41.1.....	30.3.....	Patna.....		38.4.....	25.6.....
Coimbatore.....		34.4.....	24.2.....	Port Blair.....	6.....	29.6.....	25.6.....
Dehradun.....		38.6.....	23.5.....	Puducherry.....		39.1.....	28.5.....
Gangtok.....	23.....	22.7.....	15.7.....	Pune.....		36.7.....	26.1.....
Goa.....		34.6.....	27.6.....	Raipur.....		44.5.....	31.0.....
Guwahati.....	30.....	31.8.....	23.4.....	Ranchi.....		39.3.....	26.0.....
Hubballi.....		33.0.....	23.0.....	Shillong.....	22.....	24.4.....	13.8.....
Hyderabad.....		41.0.....	29.0.....	Shimla.....		31.1.....	20.2.....
Imphal.....	0.9.....	28.1.....	21.7.....	Srinagar.....	1.....	26.0.....	9.6.....
Jaipur.....		43.2.....	32.2.....	Thiruvananthapuram.....		32.7.....	25.6.....
Kochi.....	5.....	31.4.....	26.2.....	Tiruchi.....		38.7.....	27.4.....
Kohima.....		26.0.....	17.0.....	Vijayawada.....		44.2.....	31.0.....
Kolkata.....		37.8.....	30.0.....	Visakhapatnam.....		35.7.....	30.4.....

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing

CITIES	SO ₂	NO ₂	CO	PM _{2.5}	PM ₁₀	CODE	Yesterday
Ahmedabad.....	18	71	16		38		In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Mandi
Bengaluru.....	16	19	46		37		Gobindgarh, Punjab
Bengaluru.....	5	6	41		67		recorded an overall air
Delhi.....	39	85		241	311		quality index (AQI) score
Hyderabad.....	17	18	24	60	97		of 341 indicating an
Kolkata.....	8	22	24	77	105		unhealthy level of
Lucknow.....	7	47	56	216	142		pollution. In contrast,
Mumbai.....	56	46	15	48	54		Ambarnath, Maharashtra
Pune.....	7	28	103	20	43		recorded a healthy AQI
Visakhapatnam.....	7	33	15	54	121		score of 22

Air Quality Code: ■ Poor ■ Moderate ■ Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO₂: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM_{2.5} & PM₁₀: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

Woman from Uganda with Ebola symptoms sparks health alert in Bengaluru

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

A suspected Ebola case triggered a health alert in Bengaluru after a 28-year-old woman from Uganda, who developed mild symptoms including body ache, was shifted from a hotel to the State-run Epidemic Diseases Hospital on Tuesday.

Recent travel

Bengaluru District Surgeon and Medical Superintendent of the hospital Anil Kumar Banagar said the woman had recently travelled from Uganda to Ahmedabad and had later arrived in Bengaluru.

Although she did not show symptoms during airport screening, health authorities continued to monitor her because of her travel history from an Ebola-affected region.

"The district surveillance team and airport health officials were tracking her condition. She developed a mild body ache

The World Health Organisation had declared the ongoing Ebola outbreak a public health emergency of international concern

nearly 24 hours later, following which samples were collected and sent to the National Institute of Virology (NIV), Pune," Dr. Banagar told *The Hindu*.

He said the woman was stable and had not developed any additional symptoms so far.

"The test reports are expected in a day or two. Even if the result is negative, as per protocol, a repeat test will be conducted after 48 hours of observation. She will be discharged only after testing negative twice," Dr. Banagar said.

Amid the Ebola alert, Karnataka's Health Department has designated specialised isolation, quaran-

tine and treatment facilities at government hospitals in Bengaluru and Mangaluru as part of precautionary preparedness measures.

In Bengaluru, Rajiv Gandhi Institute of Chest Diseases has been identified as the isolation centre, while Epidemic Diseases Hospital has been designated as the quarantine and treatment facility.

In Mangaluru, Srinivas Port Hospital under the New Mangalore Port Authority has been identified as the quarantine centre.

The preparedness measures follow directions issued by the Union Health Ministry asking all States and Union Territories to strengthen surveillance, hospital preparedness, and rapid response systems. The World Health Organisation had recently declared the ongoing Ebola outbreak in Uganda and the Democratic Republic of Congo a "Public Health Emergency of International Concern" (PHEIC).

CENTRAL RAILWAY CORRIGENDUM NO. 1

Tender No. CR-BB-SNT-NORTH-2026-40
Corrigendum No 1 is been issued for tender no CR-BB-SNT-NORTH-2026-40, and details can be viewed on Website at www.ireps.gov.in, This tender complies with Public Procurement Policy (Make in India) Order 2017, dated 15/06/2017, Rest all other terms and conditions remain the same., All other details can be viewed on Website at www.ireps.gov.in. 191

Keep your animals away from railway lines

CENTRAL RAILWAY SIGNALING WORK

Divisional Railway Manager (S&T), 1st Floor, Parcel Office Building, above P.F.No.14 & 15, Central Railway, Mumbai CST. 400 001, for and on behalf of the President of India Invites Open tenders from the reputed contractors. **SN: 1, Name of work:** Signaling work in connection with Fencing work in KALYAN - KARJAT LONAVALA and KARJAT -KHOPOLI section in Mumbai division., **TENDER NO:- CR-BB-SNT-North-2026-50, Approximate Cost:** Rs. 2.92Cr. **Date of Opening:** 22.06.2026, **EMD:** Rs 585000/-, **Validity:** 60 days, **Completion Period:** 12 Months., This tender complies with Public Procurement Policy (Make in India) Order 2017, dated 15/06/2017, Complete details of tenders are available at Central Railway. Official website www.ireps.gov.in the complete tender documents can be downloaded from the website. The complete details of tenders are also available in the "Notice Board" of the Divisional Railway Manager (S&T)'s Office, Mumbai CST. 188

Keep your animals away from railway lines

SOUTH EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY E-TENDER NOTICE

S.N. (I) E-Tender No. CPM-ENG-GSU-BSP-03-26-27, Date: 13.05.2026

"Work: (i) Soft up gradation of CPH, KRBA, AKT, NIA & BUA station through Amrit Bharat Station Scheme phase-II. (ii) Soft up gradation work of BRJN & BPH stations through Amrit Bharat Station Scheme phase-II. (iii) Development of second entry and modernisation of all platforms along with all allied facilities at Uslapur Railway Station. (iv) Soft Upgradation of all platforms of AKT, NIA, CPH, BUA, RIG, BPH, BRJN & KRBA Railway Stations." **Tender Value (In Rs.): 65,23,75,037.88/-, EMD (In Rs.): 1,30,47,500.00/-, Completion Period:** 24 Months., **Start date of Submission of Tender:** From 04.06.2026, **Last date of Submission of Tender:** Upto 15:30 hrs. on 18.06.2026.

The complete information of above E-Tender Notice is available over websites <https://www.ireps.gov.in>. Bids other than e-bids shall not be accepted against above Tenders.

Dy. Chief Engg./GSU
CPR/10/123 S.E.C. Railway, Bilaspur
South East Central Railway @secrail

BUSINESS CONNECT

GRT Announces Exchange Mela



GRT Jewellers has announced its much-awaited Gold Exchange Mela, encouraging customers to exchange their old gold and be a part of a larger movement towards strengthening India's future. As part of this limited-period initiative, customers can receive an additional Rs.150 per gram on old gold exchange. Speaking about the initiative, Mr. G.R. 'Anand' Ananthapadmanabhan, Managing Director, GRT Jewellers, said, "Gold has always been a valuable part of Indian families and traditions." Mr. G.R. Radhakrishnan, Managing Director, GRT Jewellers, added, "At GRT Jewellers, every initiative is designed around customer benefit and long-term value."

Ports Achieve 107 MMT



Chennai Port Authority (ChPA) and Kamarajar Port Limited (KPL) announced their operational and financial highlights for FY 2025-26. The combined cargo throughput reached 107 million metric tonnes (MMT), surpassing last year's 103.37 MMT. Chennai Port handled 57.90 MMT, while KPL managed 49.08 MMT. Chennai Port recorded 1,905,658 TEUs in container throughput and significant growth in crude oil, automobile, and clean cargo. Kamarajar Port excelled in coal, container, and automobile handling. Financially, their combined operating income exceeded Rs. 2,400 crore, with Chennai Port achieving Rs. 1,185.01 crore and KPL Rs. 1,239.15 crore. Noteworthy investments included Rs. 992 crore in capital expenditures for infrastructure upgrades and trade facilitation efforts.

Hublot Hosts Watches and Wonders



Luxury Swiss watchmaker Hublot hosted an exclusive evening at the Helvetica House in Chennai. The highlight of the evening was the presence of Nitish Kumar Reddy, who is a friend of the brand and the Chief Guest for the evening. Guests at the event experienced an exclusive showcase of Hublot's latest collection, which was recently displayed at the Geneva Watches & Wonders event in April 2026. The collection includes Big Bang, Impact One Million, Big Bang Reloaded, Kylian Mbappe and more. The MD of Helvetica, Mr Teerath Doshi, also spoke at the event.

A Business Initiative

Casagrand Launches Communities



Casagrand has launched two landmark residential communities in Chennai: Casagrand Aquagrove, a premium waterfront luxury apartment development overlooking Puzhal Lake, and Casagrand Glenmere, a contemporary villa community in South Chennai. Casagrand Aquagrove features 544 high-rise apartments designed for expansive lake views and ventilation, with homes starting at Rs. 89 lakhs and 85 percent dedicated to open space, including 95+ amenities. Meanwhile, Casagrand Glenmere offers 110 3 BHK villas from Rs. 1.34 crore, emphasizing privacy and contemporary living. Both projects are strategically located near key transport routes and essential amenities, ensuring a thriving lifestyle and strong investment potential.

Launch of Honda City MMC



Honda Cars proudly launched the New Honda City MMC at Capital Honda. This latest edition combines sophisticated styling, advanced technology, enhanced comfort, and superior performance, with prices starting at Rs. 11,99,900 (ex-showroom). Key upgrades include the Blade-Eye Signature LED Lighting System, B-LED Projector Headlamps, and a refreshed exterior design. Representatives from Capital Honda emphasised that the model is designed to meet modern car buyers' evolving aspirations. The launch event featured national tennis player Mr. Ajay Selvaraj and popular playback singer Mr. Sai Charan. Attendees enjoyed firsthand experiences of the vehicle and expressed excitement over its premium features and advanced technology.

The Biggest Jewellery Festival



Joyalukkas has launched 'The Biggest Jewellery Festival of the Year' from 15 May to 14 June 2026 across all showrooms. The festival features two key benefits: a flat 0 percent deduction on old gold exchange from any jeweller and a flat 40 percent off on wastage/ making charges for gold, diamond, precious stone, platinum, and silver jewellery. Customers can choose from over one million designs and enjoy seamless gold exchanges or instant cash in as little as 15 minutes. Dr Joy Alukkas, Chairman and Managing Director, stated, "Old gold holds immense value, not just for individual families, but for our nation as a whole." Every purchase includes lifelong maintenance, complimentary insurance, and full buyback assurance.

CENTRAL RAILWAY REPLACEMENT OF WORK

Open E-tender Notice No. KYN-LD-585-W-765-Cont
SN: 1, Name of work: Replacement of corroded steel structures in Diwa-Kalyan- Igatpuri (NE) section of Mumbai Division for improving safety and reliability., **Approx. Value :** 86674523.42, **EMD ₹:** 1733500.00, **Cost of Tender Form:** 0.00, **Completion period:** 24 months, The time and date for submission of tender will be up to 11:00 Hrs on 16.06.2026. Complete details of E-tender are available at official Railway website <http://www.ireps.gov.in> the complete documents can be downloaded from the website. The detail of tender is available in the "Notice Board" of the Sr.DEE(TD) KYN's office, Kalyan. 190

Keep your animals away from railway lines

CENTRAL RAILWAY CORRIGENDUM No. 1

Tender No. CR-BB-TELE-2026-41
Corrigendum No 1 is been issued for tender no CR-BB-TELE-2026-41, 1. Tender Document is up loaded., 2. Tender closing date is extended up to 16.06.2026 15.00 Hrs., Details can be viewed on Website at www.ireps.gov.in, Rest all other terms and conditions remain the same., This tender complies with Public Procurement Policy Order 2017 dated 15.06.2017 197

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CENTRAL RAILWAY CORRIGENDUM No. 1

Tender No. CR-BB-TELE-2026-54
Corrigendum No 1 is been issued for tender no CR-BB-TELE-2026-54, 1. **Tender Document is up loaded.,** Details can be viewed on Website at www.ireps.gov.in, Rest all other terms and conditions remain the same., **This tender complies with Public Procurement Policy Order 2017 dated 15.06.2017** 198

Keep your animals away from railway lines



Bad fences

Marco Rubio's visit was an opportunity to mend economic and energy ties

Secretary of State Marco Rubio's four-day visit to India, his first since taking office in January 2025, was understood to have been aimed at smoothing bilateral ties that have been deeply ruptured over the past year. The problems have been multifold, ranging from the U.S.'s high tariffs and cutting down on visas, immigration and outsourcing; to sanctions on India's energy procurement and investment, its moves with China and Pakistan, and the pejorative remarks by President Donald Trump and his cabinet colleagues about India. Although the Modi government has not criticised the U.S. for its actions, there is no doubt that the U.S. attack on Iran on February 28, the wider regional conflict and the Hormuz Strait blockade, have caused immense economic worries for India as well. It was thus hoped that Mr. Rubio's visit, which combined the bilateral agenda alongside the Quad Foreign Ministers' meeting, would help repair one of the worst phases in bilateral ties caused largely by Washington's unilateral moves. Mr. Rubio consistently held that the relationship was well and that "President Trump loves India", while responding to repeated questions on Mr. Trump's post that amplified anti-immigrant sentiments referring to India as a "hell-hole". New Delhi had no doubt laid out the red carpet for Mr. Rubio. In a departure from protocol, Prime Minister Narendra Modi welcomed him on his arrival and External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar spent much of the weekend in meetings with Mr. Rubio, including two U.S. Embassy receptions. On Sunday, Mr. Jaishankar attended a celebration marking the U.S.'s 250th Independence Day and Mr. Rubio's birthday. Mr. Rubio visited the Missionaries of Charity, in Kolkata, and went to Agra and Jaipur for sightseeing. In bilateral talks, the Foreign Ministers discussed the full gamut of ties, including trade, energy, civil nuclear technological and defence cooperation, as well as the regional and geopolitical conflicts.

However, apart from one agreement on critical minerals cooperation, which replicates their partnership within the Quad and the 15-nation Pax Silica, the visit's bilateral part ended with few outcomes of note. Mr. Rubio's refusal to acknowledge a problem in the relationship indicates that the U.S., once considered India's most trusted partnership, has failed to recognise New Delhi's concerns. It is hoped, however, that Mr. Rubio was informed of them, as both sides prepare for a possible Modi-Trump meeting at the G-7 Summit in Evian, France, in mid-June, where India is a special invitee. This will be the first time that the leaders have come face to face since Mr. Modi's February 2025 Washington visit and all that followed, and an opportunity to mend the relationship especially in the areas it has frayed the most – economic, energy and regional security.

Score board

The CBSE was ill-prepared for the examination reforms it undertook

India's education system is under severe stress. The NEET fiasco which caused immense suffering to nearly 22 lakh students exposed the deep structural flaws within the National Testing Agency, where one part conducts the JEE seamlessly while another appears clueless and completely out of its depth in conducting another high-stakes examination. The Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) has caused much anxiety to and harmed a significant proportion of some 18 lakh students who took the Class 12 exams this year and whose answer scripts were evaluated through On Screen Marking (OSM) for the first time. It appears that little training was given to the staff scanning the answer sheets, and that no SOPs were in place after consultations with experts. Yet, some one crore sets of answer papers were scanned in record time. Evaluators were not really put through the paces; not prepped fully for the new interface; nor their screen fatigue evaluated for its impact on scoring. Ideally, OSM should first be tested on a smaller subset of answer sheets in parallel with the regular mode to evaluate whether there is any statistically significant deviation in scores between the two methods. This would have borne out whether the system was truly prepared for what was presented as a reform and allowed corrective measures before full-scale adoption.

It appears none of this was done. The result: a clear reduction in student performance, which was too significant to be dismissed as coincidence. When students received their scanned answer scripts, their fears appeared to have been validated. Widespread reports of mismatched scripts, unevaluated supplementary sheets, and unclear scans flooded social media, while many students complained that they had not received their scanned copies. To tamp down anger, the CBSE had slashed the fees for accessing answer scripts and re-evaluation while promising refunds where re-evaluation was found to be justified. More than 1.25 lakh students applied for accessing nearly four lakh answer scripts within a few hours of the window opening. Since then, the deadline for script access was extended repeatedly before ending on May 25. The CBSE has not yet revealed the plans for re-evaluation which is likely to be of a higher order this year. The Education Minister has said that the IITs have now been involved in troubleshooting. What is at stake is not just the CBSE's credibility but also the future of lakhs of students. The immediate task before the CBSE is to carry out the re-evaluation to the satisfaction of students. A long-term task would be to honestly address the root causes of the fiasco and implement solutions.

The Strait of Hormuz is no longer just a geopolitical flashpoint; it has become the fault line of the global energy economy. As tensions in West Asia continue to disrupt shipping through one of the world's most critical maritime corridors, countries across the globe are confronting a harsh reality: energy security is now inseparable from geopolitics. For India, which depends on imports for the overwhelming majority of its crude oil needs, the crisis has exposed both the strength of recent policy interventions and the limits of shielding consumers indefinitely from market realities.

The immediate impact of the conflict has been visible in global crude markets. Brent prices have surged sharply amid fears of prolonged disruption to Gulf supplies, while freight costs and marine insurance premiums have climbed to multi-year highs. Shipping routes are being diverted around the Cape of Good Hope, extending delivery timelines by weeks and significantly increasing transportation expenses. Global gas markets, too, remain under pressure following disruptions linked to the shutdown of key liquefied natural gas export infrastructure in Qatar. Despite this turbulence, the crisis has not hit Indian consumers as ferociously as it should be so far. Petrol and diesel prices at Indian fuel pumps have remained relatively stable, hovering near ₹95 per litre in many cities, even as fuel prices in several advanced economies rose steeply, by about 25% on average. Petrol prices in Germany and the United Kingdom have crossed the equivalent of roughly ₹220 and ₹204 per litre, respectively, while Hong Kong continues to record some of the world's highest fuel prices at nearly ₹291 per litre. This stability is not a coincidence. It has been achieved through an extraordinary combination of state intervention, supply diversification, and financial absorption by public sector oil companies.

Interventions that come at a steep cost

Over the past few years, India has quietly built a more resilient energy architecture. The country expanded its sourcing basket beyond the Gulf, increased strategic reserves, and strengthened ties with suppliers in Russia, the United States, West Africa, and the Atlantic basin. Union Petroleum Minister Hardeep Singh Puri recently reiterated that India's crude supply position remains secure despite disruptions around the Strait of Hormuz, pointing to the country's growing ability to source oil from non-Gulf origins and maintain refinery throughput at high levels.

Taking advantage of the exit of the United Arab Emirates (UAE) from the Organization of the Petroleum Exporting Countries, India signed an agreement with the UAE to store 30 millions of crude oil in India's Strategic Petroleum Reserve. The government's response since the latest



Thiruvannathapuram S. Ramakrishnan

Public policy expert

escalation has been swift. Refineries were directed to maximise LPG production to meet rising domestic demand, especially given the dramatic expansion of cooking gas access under the Ujjwala scheme. LPG connections in India have risen from roughly 14.5 crore in 2014 to more than 33 crore today, fundamentally transforming household energy consumption patterns. Gas allocation was prioritised for households, public transport networks, and fertilizer plants to avoid cascading disruptions across essential sectors. Domestic LPG production was reportedly increased by nearly 50% during the peak of the crisis response, while all 25 fertilizer plants continued receiving around 70% of their gas requirements to maintain agricultural supply chains. Naval deployments in the Gulf of Oman, diplomatic engagement with multiple countries, and efforts to secure alternative shipping arrangements underline how seriously India has treated the crisis. These measures have bought the country valuable time. But they have also come at a steep cost.

Pressures on oil firms

India's state-run Oil Marketing Companies (OMC) are now operating under enormous financial stress, selling fuel below market-linked costs in order to protect consumers from inflationary shocks. Mr. Puri recently indicated that under-recoveries could rise sharply if elevated crude prices persist, with some estimates placing daily losses near ₹700 crore-₹800 crore during peak volatility. The government has already reduced excise duties and imposed temporary export restrictions on refined fuels to retain supplies within the domestic market.

This strategy may be politically prudent in the short term, but is economically difficult to sustain over a prolonged period. Energy subsidies of this scale eventually strain public finances, weaken the balance sheets of oil companies, and distort market signals that encourage efficient energy consumption.

The larger challenge is that India's vulnerability is structural, not temporary. Nearly every major sector of the economy – transport, logistics, aviation, manufacturing, agriculture, and fertilizers – remains heavily dependent on imported fossil fuels. Even if India succeeds in avoiding immediate shortages, it cannot remain permanently insulated from a prolonged global energy shock.

There are already signs that the government recognises this reality. Prime Minister Narendra Modi's appeals for responsible energy use – including reducing unnecessary travel, conserving fuel, and encouraging remote work where feasible – reflect an administration preparing the public for a period of prolonged uncertainty. Such messaging would have seemed extraordinary only a few years ago. Today, it

The petro products price hike is too little and too late

Rajya Sabha defections, constitutional questions

The recent developments within the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP), appear to have dealt a decisive blow to its representation in the Rajya Sabha. On April 24, 2026, seven out of its 10 sitting Members of Parliament, publicly announced that over two-thirds of the party's MPs had decided to merge with the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP), invoking the provisions of the 10th Schedule of the Constitution.

While the development has attracted widespread political attention, its implications extend beyond immediate partisan concerns. It raises significant constitutional questions regarding the interpretation of the anti-defection law, particularly the scope of the "merger" exception under the 10th Schedule. Nor is the episode entirely unprecedented. Similar assertions of legislative strength have been witnessed at the State level, most notably in the case of the Eknath Shinde-led faction in the Shiv Sena within the Maharashtra Assembly. However, the present instance assumes greater significance as it unfolds at the national level, involving MPs in the Rajya Sabha, thereby amplifying its constitutional and political consequences.

Anti-defection framework, 'split' doctrine

The Constitution, as originally adopted in 1950, provided for disqualification of MPs on limited grounds under Article 103, to be decided by the President of India acting on the opinion of the Election Commission of India. The 10th Schedule, introduced by the 52nd Constitution Amendment Act, 1985, expanded this framework to address the persistent problem of political defections adding another ground for disqualification of members to be decided by the Speaker or Chairman. The objective was to curb the practice of elected representatives abandoning their parties for political gain, by attaching the consequence of disqualification.

At the same time, the Schedule originally carved out two exceptions, "split" under Paragraph 3 and "merger" under Paragraph 4. The first, which recognised a split in a legislature party where one-third of its members formed a



Vanshaj Azad

Advocate, presently working as Law Clerk-cum-Research Associate at the Supreme Court of India

The recent episode involving the Aam Aadmi Party and the invocation of the provisions of the 10th Schedule highlights the need for judicial clarity

separate faction, was subsequently deleted by the 91st Constitution Amendment Act, 2003, following recommendations of Electoral Reforms (Dinesh Goswami Committee) in May 1990 and the 170th Law Commission Report, 1999. This deletion marked a conscious shift away from recognising internal fractures within legislature parties as a legitimate defence to defection.

The omission of Paragraph 3 carries deeper implications. The concept of "split" had implicitly recognised a degree of autonomy in the legislature party vis-à-vis the political party. Its removal signals Parliament's clear intent to restore primacy to the political party as the central unit of democratic accountability.

The Supreme Court of India has also reinforced this position in Subhash Desai vs Principal Secretary, Governor of Maharashtra (2023), where a Constitution Bench declined to interpret the 10th Schedule in a manner that severs the figurative umbilical cord between a legislature party and its parent political party. The Court underscored that the political party continues to guide and control the actions of its elected members, even after electoral victory.

The merger exception in question

The present controversy centres on the interpretation of Paragraph 4 of the 10th Schedule, which provides immunity from disqualification in cases of merger. The key question is whether such a merger can be effected solely by two-thirds of the members of a legislature party, or whether it must necessarily be preceded by, or reflect, a decision of the original political party itself.

A plain reading of Paragraph 4 suggests that the exemption applies where the "original political party" merges with another political party. The emphasis, therefore, is on the merger of the political party, not merely a numerical alignment within the legislature party. Hence, Paragraph 4(2), which introduces a deeming fiction based on the consent of two-thirds of legislators, cannot be read in isolation so as to displace the primacy of the political organisation.

appears pragmatic. There is a strong argument for calibrated correction. India has managed inflation relatively effectively over the past decade compared to many major economies, creating some room for a measured increase in petroleum prices without triggering runaway inflation. Consumer Price Index inflation remained comparatively moderate in early 2026 – at around 3.2% to 3.5% through the first four months of the year – suggesting that limited price rationalisation may still be economically manageable. A gradual pass-through of global energy costs would reduce the fiscal burden on the state, stabilise oil marketing companies, and encourage more responsible consumption patterns.

For now, India has demonstrated remarkable agility in navigating one of the most serious energy disruptions in modern history. Supplies remain stable, panic has been avoided, and the government has managed to shield ordinary citizens from the worst immediate consequences.

The realities of a new energy era

But energy shocks of this scale eventually demand economic realism. The true cost of fuel cannot be deferred forever. India's challenge is no longer merely surviving the crisis; it is preparing the public and the economy for a world in which energy security will remain fragile, contested, and deeply political for years to come.

Recent reports suggest that Indian refiners continue to diversify sourcing aggressively even as global analysts warn that a prolonged Hormuz disruption could widen India's fiscal deficit and weaken the rupee. That should serve as a reminder that the situation is not a temporary headline cycle. It marks the beginning of a new energy era – one in which resilience, diversification, and conservation will matter as much as diplomacy itself. The government has raised petroleum product prices several times, cumulatively by about 7%. Yet, this piecemeal approach neither matches international crude oil prices adequately nor meaningfully reduces the burden on OMCs. Reports suggest that OMCs continue to incur losses of ₹700 crore to ₹800 crore a day, and that only an additional 13% hike, beyond the existing 7%, would eliminate these losses. It has also been reported that the government has returned to adjusting fuel prices in line with fluctuations in international crude oil prices. However, frequent revisions create uncertainty for consumers trying to manage household and business budgets. Instead of incremental increases, the government should implement a one-time price hike of at least 13% on petroleum products, including petrol, diesel, and aviation turbine fuel. Such a move, though difficult, would reduce uncertainty, stabilise OMC finances, and allow prices to remain steady until there is a significant shift in global crude prices.

To do so would invert the constitutional design, effectively allowing the legislature party to dictate the fate of the political party.

This interpretation would be inconsistent with Parliament's decision in exercise of constituent power to abolish the "split" exception, which had earlier permitted even a one-third faction to claim legitimacy. The threshold may have changed, but the principle remains that the internal dissent within the legislature party cannot override the identity and continuity of the political party.

Beyond technicalities

At a broader level, the anti-defection law was not merely intended to regulate individual conduct but to preserve the integrity of the party system and, by extension, the institution of 'opposition' in democracy. While it does not entirely prohibit political realignments, it subjects them to constitutional discipline.

The recent AAP episode underscores the need for judicial clarity on whether legislative majorities can, in effect, appropriate the identity of the political party they were elected to represent. The answer will have far-reaching implications for parliamentary democracy.

As lyricist and former parliamentarian Javed Akhtar once observed in the Rajya Sabha, the essential distinction between democracy and dictatorship lies in the presence of an opposition. It is this opposition that the 10th Schedule seeks to safeguard. AAP has approached the Chairman of the Rajya Sabha under Paragraph 6 of the 10th Schedule to challenge the action of its seven "merged" MPs.

How the merger exception is ultimately interpreted will be significant, particularly for the continued vitality of the Opposition. In the absence of settled judicial clarity, the issue is likely, sooner rather than later, to invite authoritative determination by the Supreme Court. The hope, ultimately, is that constitutional adjudication will preserve the centrality of political parties within India's parliamentary framework.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Destroying merit system

The Supreme Court of India has rightly observed that the National Testing Agency (NTA) "has not learnt its lesson" even after the 2024 controversy (Front page, May 26). Repeated leaks and examination failures are

destroying students' trust in merit and fairness. Lakhs of hardworking youngsters now feel let down by the very system that is meant to reward talent. Such frustration is creating public anger, political cynicism, and even the rise of terms such as the "Cockroach

Janta Party" to mock a system seen as surviving despite repeated scandals. Many students are also choosing foreign universities and migration over staying in India. If examination bodies lose credibility, the nation risks losing an entire generation's

confidence in institutions. Therefore, transparency, accountability, and strict reforms in bodies such as the NTA are urgently needed. **Sam Oommen,** Venmoney, Chengannur, Kerala

It is unfortunate that the

NTA has been unable to develop a foolproof system to safeguard question papers and prevent leaks. The lapse on the part of the NTA is indefensible, as the future of lakhs of students across the country stands compromised. Even more galling is the

recurrence of such leaks – a sign of a chronic malaise hardly befitting an institution of the NTA's stature.

C.V. Aravind, Bengaluru

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

The absolute necessity of female friendships

An enduring fiction about female friendship is that it is a leisure activity, an indulgence that exists on the margins of real life. For adult Indian women, this real life is imagined as marriage, children, domestic work and caregiving, and in some cases, paid work too (and in rarer cases, perhaps even a career). If one does not understand how female friendship can be a lifeline, it is easy to dismiss the time spent sustaining it as wasteful.

To appreciate the significance of female friendship, one must first understand the profound social isolation that defines the lives of countless Indian women.

Aside from writing fiction, the author of this article builds human-centred technology products at a nonprofit working in maternal and child health. A lot of time in this line of work is spent talking to and learning about diverse women from different parts of the country in order to understand how they access information, make decisions and exercise agency, especially around health and nutrition. Through such conversations and research, the author realised how difficult it was for Indian women to maintain friendships after marriage, and as a consequence, how uncommon it is for married women to have close friends.

Documented gap

According to a Gallup poll from 2004 (incidentally, the same year the popular sitcom *Friends* aired its last season), the average American woman had eight close friends.

In contrast, more recent studies by the World Bank show that rural women in Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and Uttarakhand have between one and three close social connections outside the family. In many ways, this is not surprising; in most parts of the country, women move homes – sometimes even towns and States – after marriage, and while more women than ever before now own



Amrita Mahale
Author of the novels 'Milk Teeth' and 'Real Life'. She also works in public health

smartphones, there are gatekeepers who supervise and dictate their use of technology. Even if they were to reside in the same village or town, it is not much easier for women to keep in touch with a friend.

According to the most recent National Family Health Survey (NFHS-5), only 42% of Indian women are allowed to travel alone outside the home, even to the market or to access health facilities. Additionally, over 10% of married women reported not being allowed to meet female friends.

Method of isolation

This social isolation of young women is neither an accident, nor simply an unfortunate by-product of social norms. Limiting women's access to information and values which can challenge the status quo preserves patriarchal control over them.

A 2021 study from Uttar Pradesh showed that the number of peers a married woman has (or perhaps it is more appropriate to say, is 'allowed to have') shrinks when her mother-in-law does not approve of family planning or if the mother-in-law wants her to have more children, specifically more sons, than the younger woman herself would prefer to have. By restricting a young wife's ability to form friendships and consult with peers, the family can ensure that the preferences of the husband and the in-laws prevail, especially in critical decisions around fertility and family planning.

While this may seem far removed from our own lives and contexts, modern urban living introduces its own barriers to connection: the twin crises of time and space. Women across classes shoulder the double burden of professional and domestic work. Compared to their rural counterparts, urban women face another key disadvantage: nuclear family units leave women without the built-in "village" of female kin that can provide a buffer against

domestic stress. Friendship is one of the first casualties of this time-poverty.

Sociologist Ray Oldenburg coined the term "third places" for spaces of social gathering distinct from home and work. He argued that community and democracy thrive in third places; and friendships do, too. For many urban women today, safe, non-commercial spaces to congregate are vanishing.

A potential lifeline

Ironically, the dismissal of friendship as unimportant hurts men just as deeply. We are currently witnessing a silent epidemic of male loneliness, where men, conditioned to prioritise stoicism and side-by-side activities over face-to-face connection and vulnerability, often reach middle age with no emotional support system outside of their marriage.

If men were to value friendship with the same intensity that women do, if they were to view it as an essential nutrient for a fulfilling life rather than a mere garnish, they might find themselves not only healthier, but less threatened by the women who have known this secret all along.

Female friendship can be an emotional, social and political lifeline for women. Our friends show us different ways of being in the world. They teach us how to take up space, how to challenge power and bargain with it. Perhaps this is what society fears. We often imagine the fight for women's empowerment as a public spectacle, as marches, protests, and activism, but this fight can take a very different form as well.

For many women in this country, sustaining and safeguarding female friendship – be it in the form of a catch-up on the phone, an exchange of messages on WhatsApp, or a walk around the neighbourhood late in the evening – is no less than an act of resistance.

A new brand of politics in Tamil Nadu

Though a novice, CM Vijay shows signs of being a shrewd political strategist

STATE OF PLAY

B. Kolappan

It appears that the Tamila Vetti Kazhagam (TVK), led by actor-turned-politician C. Joseph Vijay, has triggered a political upheaval in Tamil Nadu following the 2026 Assembly elections. In many ways, Mr. Vijay has demonstrated that a Chief Ministerial candidate need not necessarily hail from a numerically dominant community, backed by entrenched political networks to capture power in Tamil Nadu. Equally significant is the fact that he has become the first Christian Chief Minister to head a coalition government in the State's history.

The ascent of the TVK to power in Tamil Nadu has posed a formidable challenge to the two principal Dravidian parties, the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) and the All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (AIADMK), which have alternated in power in the State for more than half a century. Tamil Nadu politics appears to have evolved into a contest between the charisma and mass appeal of Mr. Vijay – carefully cultivated through cinema and popular culture – and the leaders of the two Dravidian majors, who continue to invoke and defend the Dravidian legacy whenever they perceive a political threat.

Breaking from tradition

Mr. Vijay heads a remarkably young government. Barring senior figures such as K. A. Sengottaiyan and N. Anand, most Ministers and MLAs are relatively young and possess little to no independent political capital. Moreover, the traditional white dhoti emblazoned with party colours on its border no longer defines



the political culture of the TVK. The Chief Minister is often seen in sharply tailored formal suits, while many of his MLAs appear in white shirts and black trousers, projecting the image of a new political generation eager to break from convention. In several constituencies, voters scarcely know the names of their MLAs; instead, it was the 'whistle' symbol of the party, the charisma of Mr. Vijay, and the electorate's yearning for political change that shaped the electoral verdict.

The composition of the Cabinet also marks a striking departure from previous regimes. It includes eight Ministers from the Scheduled Caste (SC) community, among them Vanni Arasu of the Vidthalai Chiruthaigal Katchi (VCK) and P. Viswanathan from the Congress. The Ministry also features four women entrusted with major portfolios. Traditionally, departments such as Industries, Animal Husbandry and Dairy Development were regarded as male bastions. Under the TVK government, however, these influential portfolios are being handled by women Ministers, signalling a conscious attempt to redefine the contours of political representation in Tamil Nadu.

The manner in which Mr. Vijay, despite securing only 108 seats, managed to garner support for his government also bears the imprint of a

shrewd political strategist. After the Congress volunteered its support, he reached out to the leaders of the two Communist parties, the VCK and the Indian Union Muslim League. He personally engaged with their leadership, offered Cabinet berths, and won over a section of AIADMK legislators, who voted in favour of his government during the trust vote in the Assembly.

All's fair in politics

Meanwhile, the TVK appears to be steadily moving towards securing a legislative majority of its own. Mr. Vijay and his lieutenants seem to have embraced the principle that, in politics, expediency often matters more than ideology or principles. Capitalising on the growing dissent within the AIADMK, the TVK has successfully drawn dissident legislators into its fold. So far, four AIADMK MLAs have resigned their Assembly seats and joined the TVK. The apparent strategy is either to field them as TVK candidates in the ensuing by-elections or to replace them with TVK nominees.

The question of disqualifying the AIADMK MLAs who violated the party whip is now pending before the Speaker. Should the Speaker move ahead with disqualification proceedings, several vacancies could arise in the Assembly. The TVK appears confident that it can win enough seats in the subsequent by-elections to secure a clear majority, thereby freeing itself from dependence on outside support.

Though a political novice, Mr. Vijay seems to have quickly learnt that power often rewards those willing to pursue victory through strategic calculation and relentless manoeuvring.

kolappan.b@thehindu.co.in

NCDs accounted for 60% of all deaths in 2022-2024

Non-communicable diseases are increasingly becoming the major cause of death even among women and the rural population

DATA POINT

Bindu Shajan Perappadan

India's youth mortality profile is shifting with Non-Communicable Diseases (NCDs) being the cause of 60% of all deaths in the 2022-2024 reporting period, according to the Sample Registration System (SRS) Statistical Report 2024, released this month. This was an increase of 7.3 percentage points compared with the 2015-2017 reporting period, when NCDs were the cause of 52.8% of all deaths (Chart 1).

Analysis showed that among the NCDs, cardiovascular diseases alone accounted for 32.1% of all deaths in 2022-2024, which is again an increase of five percentage points compared with 27.1% in 2015-2017. The combined share of communicable diseases, and maternal, perinatal and nutritional conditions as the major cause of death in India has meanwhile come down from 22% in the 2015-2017 period to 19.7% in 2022-2024.

Age-group-wise data presented in the Cause of Deaths in India: 2022-2024 report showed that while cardiovascular diseases accounted for 32.1% of all deaths caused by NCDs, they accounted for 37.3% in the 30-69 age group. Health experts note that heart-related illnesses are increasingly affecting adults in their 30s and 40s, which is a matter of concern as this age group forms a large part of the nation's workforce.

The findings assume significance as India is witnessing a decline in fertility rates. Several States are already below the replacement fertility level of 2.1 children per woman.

In the 2022-2024 reporting period, while 69.3% of deaths happened in the 55-plus age group, those aged between 30 and 44 accounted for 19.5% of deaths, making premature deaths among younger adults an economic and social concern.

Analysis of the data over the years showed notable differences between the rural and urban population and between men and women. NCDs were the cause of 64.8% of all deaths in urban areas while they accounted for only 58.8% of all deaths in rural areas. Similarly, NCDs accounted for 62.3% of all deaths among men and 56.9% among women. However, the trend of NCDs becoming the major cause of death is clearly visible even among the rural population and women (Chart 2).

After cardiovascular diseases, the top causes of death in the 2022-2024 reporting period included cancer and other neoplasms, respiratory diseases, digestive diseases and respiratory infections, each accounting for more than 5% of all deaths (Table 1).

The report suggests that India is now experiencing an epidemiological transition similar to that seen in many middle- and high-income countries, where chronic illnesses dominate mortality trends. At the same time, infectious diseases continue to remain a challenge, creating what public health experts describe as a "double burden" of disease.

Suicide remains the leading cause of death among the 15-29 age group (Table 1). Suicides accounted for 19% of deaths in this age group, compared with 16.3% in 2015-2017. The rise in suicides points to growing mental health pressures, including unemployment, academic stress, financial difficulties, and social isolation.

The report also showed stark differences between the group of eight States – Bihar, Jharkhand, Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Odisha, Rajasthan, Uttar Pradesh and Uttarakhand – which were identified for special focus for the Government under its Empowered Action Group (EAG) along with Assam and other States (Chart 3). In EAG States and Assam, NCDs accounted for 53.9% of all deaths compared with 63.5% for other States.

Cause for concern

The data for the charts were sourced from Sample Registration System – Statistical Reports and Causes of Deaths in India Reports. In the charts, EAG refers to empowered action group



CHART 1: Major causes for deaths in India over reporting periods from 2015-2017 onwards

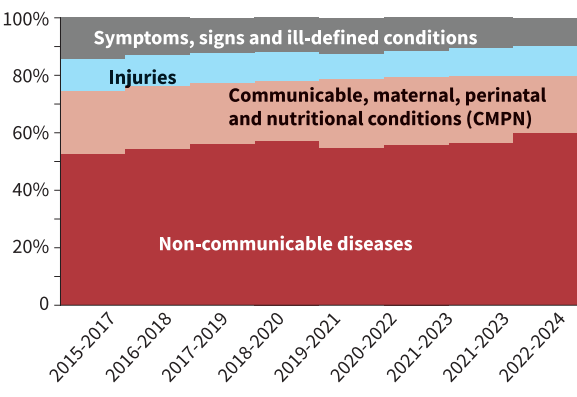


CHART 2: Share of deaths due to NCDs between rural and urban areas and men and women

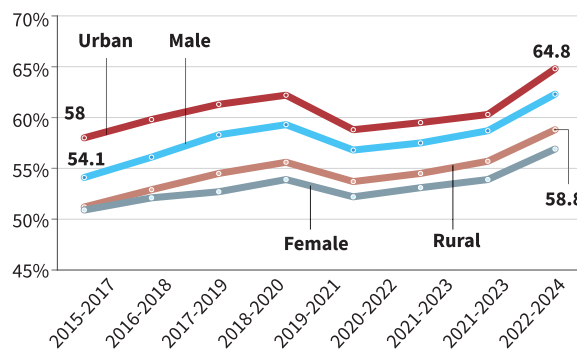


CHART 3: Share of deaths due to NCDs and communicable diseases between EAG States and Assam versus other States

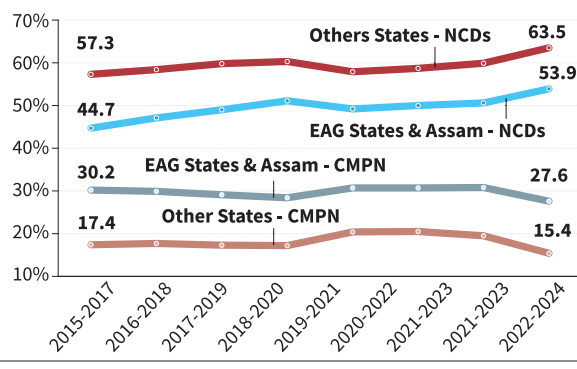


TABLE 1: Top 10 causes of deaths among all age groups, and in the 15-29 and 30-69 age groups in India

Cause	All ages (%)	Age 15-29 (%)	Age 30-69 (%)
Cardiovascular diseases	32.1	10.8	37.3
Cancer	7	4.2	10.3
Digestive diseases	5.9	7.5	8.9
Respiratory diseases	6	-	5.1
Respiratory infections	5.7	-	-
Diabetes mellitus	3.6	-	3.9
Genito-urinary diseases	3.4	-	4.7
Fever of unknown origin	4.1	3.3	-
Road accidents	-	17.7	4.2
Other unintentional injuries	4.1	8.6	3.9
Suicide	-	19	3.4
Tuberculosis	-	3.1	3.5
Neuro-psychiatric conditions	-	3	-
Ill-defined / other symptoms	9.7	3.2	-

The blank cells in the table above indicate that the respective causes were not among the top 10 causes for the corresponding age groups

As shown in the table above, road accidents and suicides disproportionately affect younger people. Deaths caused by motor vehicle accidents increased from 2.9% in 2021-2023 to 3.2% in 2022-2024 for all age groups, while deaths due to suicides rose from 2.5% to 2.8% in the same period

In Chart 1, the increase in deaths due to communicable diseases during 2019-2021 and 2020-2022 was due to COVID-19

FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu

FIFTY YEARS AGO MAY 27, 1976

No let-up in campaign against coloured in UK

London, May 26: The campaign against the coloured in Britain goes on unabated and if the present trend continues, with right-wing reactionaries making the most of it an explosive situation may develop soon.

The coloured community has been stunned into a kind of silence, a silence born of fear. Thousands of Asian families here are seriously considering going back home provided economic circumstances permit.

But, with the exception of a tiny minority, most Asian families lead a hand-to-mouth existence. Some live comfortably but save little and a lot of them are exploited by British employers as a source of cheap, disciplined labour. They know that white workers in many menial jobs would tend to be callous and "outright lazy" in the words of a white garment factory owner I spoke to the other day.

The recent developments raise many questions about Britain's claim to be a non-racist liberal society. The British media, which are supposed to maintain "high moral standards" and which regard themselves as custodians of the moral and intellectual values of the world, continue to hammer at the race issue in such a way that public opinion is getting highly prejudiced against the coloured.

The Labour government is right now fighting a battle of words with Tory right-wing leaders about the number of dependents of coloured British who want to migrate here.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO MAY 27, 1926

Laying of new trans-atlantic cable

Rugby, May 27: The shore end of the greatest submarine cable in the world is to be landed at Land's End to-day provided weather conditions are favourable. Three miles of cable have already been laid seaward and is marked by a buoy ready for the time when the cable ship will proceed to lay the electric line across the Atlantic to New York via Newfoundland, total length of 4,000 miles. The cable was made at Woolwich and is being laid for the Western Union Telegraph Company, who claim it will be the fastest in world and capable of transmitting 500 words a minute across the Atlantic.

CM
YK

Fuel shortage hits pumps amid panic buying; OMCs call for calm

Petrol pump owners report dwindling supplies and long queues as demand peaks owing to farming activity; some impose curbs on sale fearing supply disruption; oil firms assure public of steady supply, and urge people to avoid hoarding fuel

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

A day after the Centre hiked fuel prices for the fourth time to cut losses of its oil marketing companies (OMCs), petrol bunks reported fuel shortage on Tuesday as people flocked to stock up despite efforts by the authorities to calm nerves and curb hoarding.

In Maharashtra, farmers in Dharashiv, Chhatrapati Sambhajanagar, and Jalna districts said they have not been able to buy diesel. In the talukas and smaller towns, there have been long lines at filling stations.

Punjab's Petrol Pump Dealers' Association said there were reports of short supply of petrol and diesel following which some retail outlets are running dry. Rajesh Kumar, secretary general of PPDA, told *The Hindu* that the association had written to the State government last week, warning it about the "critical" situation.

Bengaluru's fuel stations reported reduced supplies,



Aftermath of decision: The Centre hiked prices of petrol and diesel for the fourth time on Monday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

with several operators saying they are receiving only one tanker a day instead of the usual two loads. Fuel pump owners said the reduced supply has increased pressure during peak hours, raising fears of temporary stockouts. A 24-hour fuel station in R.R. Nagar has stopped overnight operations.

Petrol pump owners in Rajasthan have moved a public interest writ petition in the High Court over the alleged arbitrary res-

trictions imposed by OMCs on the sale of fuel. Rajasthan Petroleum Dealers' Association general secretary Shashank Korani said deliveries to pumps have dropped by 30% to 35%. About 1,500 of the 6,712 fuel outlets across the State are functioning with a very low stock.

Curbs on fuel purchase were in place at certain pumps in Bihar, including in Patna and Gaya, due to limited fuel availability. Two-wheelers can fill pe-

trol for ₹200, cars for ₹1,000 and heavy vehicles up to ₹2,500.

Some have blamed panic buying for the scarcity. Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnis said there has been a sudden spurt in petrol and diesel demand that has created "a shortage-like situation" in the State.

In Kolkata, pump owners flagged hoarding of fuel amid rumours of a supply crunch. "In some pockets some pumps have gone dry, but that is mostly due to hoarding," John Mukherjee, president of Indian Oil Dealers Forum, West Bengal, said.

While no supply shortage was noticed at fuel stations in Madhya Pradesh's Bhopal, some have put limits on large-scale commercial sales.

Though there has been no shortage in Andhra Pradesh, the State's petroleum traders federation president Raavi Gopala Krishna said he has noticed "a nearly 10% to 15% drop in fuel consumption, particularly petrol, after the suc-

cessive price hikes."

In Tamil Nadu, V.C. Asokan, State-level co-ordinator for the oil industry, said a few days ago there was an increase in sale due to increased agricultural activities and a visible shift of institutional customers to retail outlets. In Telangana, OMCs said there has been an increase in demand for petroleum products in recent times due to intensified agricultural and harvesting activities.

'No uncertainty'

Oil companies assured the public on Tuesday that there was no shortage of fuel and urged people to avoid "panic buying".

"BPCL continues to maintain adequate fuel availability across its retail outlets...", the company said on social media.

HPCL conveyed a message of calm, saying, "Our retail outlets across the country continue normal operations with steady fuel availability... No uncertainty. No disruption."

(With inputs from regional bureaux)

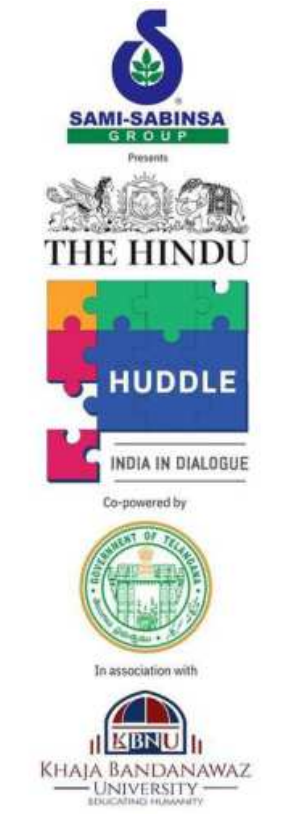
The Hindu Huddle to host session on evolving status of regional parties in India

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The evolving status of regional parties in India, especially in the wake of the recent Assembly elections, will be among the key themes at The Hindu Huddle on June 6 in Bengaluru.

The theme of The Hindu Huddle this year is 'A World in Transition'. This resonates as much within India as it does globally, with the country's multi-party system evolving with every electoral cycle. The space occupied by regional parties is changing, and in the wake of the recent Assembly election results, many have predicted a bleak future for them. But the history of regional parties shows that in a country with as many variations as India, there is never a last day for an idea.

Against this backdrop, The Huddle will host a session titled 'Nurturing our pluralist union: The role of regional politics in strengthening democracy', with Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) MP K. Kani-mozhi, Biju Janata Dal



As the title of the session suggests, the question of the place of regional parties within a single-party hegemonic polity has implications for India's democracy in terms of representation of regional aspirations. It also touches upon questions of culture, language, and literary expression.

The session will be moderated by *The Hindu's* political editor, Nistula Hebbar.

Event partners

The event is presented by Sami-Sabinsa Group as the Presenting Partner. The event is co-powered by the Government of Telangana and held In Association with Khaja Bandanawaz University. The event is further supported by: Larsen & Toubro, Apollo Hospitals, IIM Sirmara, ICAFI Group, TAfE, Wizzmon, Associate Partners; Casagrand, Realty Partner; Amity University Bengaluru, University Partner; Harrow International School Bengaluru, Education Partner; Meghalaya Tourism, State Partner; and NDTV 24x7, TV Partner.

Lawyer moves EC to register Cockroach Janta Party

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

A lawyer-activist has filed an application with the Election Commission for the registration of the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) as a political party under the Representation of the People Act.

Sudhir Jakhar, lawyer and resident of Panipat in Haryana, told *The Hindu* that he had to move in for the registration of the party as Boston-based Abhijeet Dipke who had formed the satirical platform on social media was not in a position to come to India.

Mr. Jakhar has listed himself as the National Convener of the Party.

Modi govt. is subjecting people to 'slow poisoning' through fuel hikes: Kharge

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

With compressed natural gas (CNG) prices hiked again on Tuesday, Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge accused the Narendra Modi government of subjecting people to "slow poisoning" through repeated increases in fuel prices. The people had realised the government was "incapable" of solving any issue, Mr. Kharge said.

Speaking to presspersons, Mr. Kharge said rising fuel prices, inflation, and unemployment had fuelled widespread anger against the Centre, but the

Rising fuel prices, inflation, and unemployment has fuelled anger against the Centre, he said

government was indifferent to the hardships faced by the poor. "This is Modi-ji's tactic... a kind of slow poisoning to kill poor people. They always keep increasing prices little by little, but when prices go up by ₹10-12 within just a week, it shows that Modi-ji does not want to pay attention to these issues and is instead pushing the country toward ruin," he said.

"At the same time, he keeps saying that he is doing everything for the nation, making sacrifices, and working for the people. But people here are suffering. If inflation keeps rising like this, unemployment continues to increase, factories shut down, and MSMEs and small-scale industries are forced to close, then what will happen?" he said.

In a post on X, Mr. Kharge said, citing official data, crude oil prices and the rupee-dollar exchange rate had changed significantly since 2014, yet petrol and diesel prices had continued to rise.

Cong. slams Minister's '3F' remark, says govt. ignored 'falling private investment'

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Congress on Tuesday targeted Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman over her call to focus on the "3Fs" – fuel, fertilizers and forex – with party leader Jairam Ramesh saying that she had overlooked "an all-important fourth F: falling private investment".

Mr. Ramesh's remarks

came a day after Ms. Sitharaman underscored the need to conserve foreign exchange and pay close attention to the '3Fs' amid the West Asia crisis and rising global uncertainties.

In a post on X, he said Ms. Sitharaman failed to acknowledge weakening private investment trends that, according to him, have characterised recent years.

He said net foreign direct investment inflows had declined and that private corporate investment as a share of GDP had fallen to nearly half of its pre-2014 peak. He alleged that Indian businesses are increasingly seeking more predictable and profitable opportunities abroad.

"The lack of broad-based consumer demand growth has disincentivised

companies from investing. Similarly, the overall atmosphere of threat, intimidation, and intrusiveness created by the Modi government is a psychological deterrent, as is the know-it-all attitude and approach," he said.

He questioned the Centre's fiscal position after the Reserve Bank of India announced a record dividend payout.

Can Shah be trusted on his promise to exempt tribals from UCC, asks Cong. leader

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Days after Union Minister Amit Shah promised that no form of a Uniform Civil Code (UCC) will ever be applicable to tribal areas or tribals, the Congress on Tuesday questioned whether he could be trusted, arguing that this position of the Union government evolved as a result of people opposing the UCC.

Mr. Shah made the remarks on Sunday at the Janjatiya Sankritik Samagam, organised by the Sangh Parivar-affiliated Akhil Bharatiya Vanvasi Kalyan Parishad and the Janjati Suraksha Manch here, which have a stated objective of stopping the conversion of tribal communities to Christianity and Islam and projecting the indigenous faiths and nature-worshipping cultures of tribal communities as part of the Sanatana Dharma. The event saw the top leadership of both outfits calling



Vikrant Bhuria

for a religion criterion to be added to the Constitution for the ST classification (like for SCs), and amplifying the demand to delist tribal people who had converted to Christianity or Islam.

'Ploy to reduce quotas' Responding, Vikrant Bhuria, national chairman of the Adivasi Congress, on Tuesday said the delisting movement was just a ploy to reduce the population of Scheduled Tribes, thereby providing a justification for eventually reducing the percentage of reservations

available to them in education and employment.

Mr. Bhuria also said that the Congress had always supported the demand for adding a column in Census forms for indigenous faiths of tribal communities. A movement for the demand is picking up pace in Jharkhand.

"Reservation for Scheduled Tribes was never meant to be based on religion. So, why are the BJP-RSS trying to divide Adivasis on the basis of religion?" Mr. Bhuria said.

Referring to the event, which was billed as a platform to mobilise for the protection of the faith, culture, and traditions of tribal communities across the country, he said, "The BJP has nothing to do with the culture of Adivasi people. All they care about is the land, forests, and resources that they have always had access to. We can see this happening in Great Nicobar, in Odisha, in Chhattisgarh."

KERALA HEALTH RESEARCH & WELFARE SOCIETY
(An Institution fully owned by the Government of Kerala)
Registered Office : General Hospital Campus, Red Cross Road,
Thiruvananthapuram - 695 035, Ph : 0471 - 2300377

No. A3-2245/21/KHRWS **E-Tender Notice** Date: 23-05-2026

Tenders are invited from renowned and experienced distributor / manufactures to supply equipments for Transplant Immunology Lab being set up by KHRWS at Thiruvananthapuram.

Tender details are available from KHRWS Head Office and from the websites www.khrws.kerala.gov.in and www.etenders.kerala.gov.in

Last date of online submission of tenders is 20.06.2026.

Thiruvananthapuram **Sd/- Managing Director**

GREATER VISAKHAPATNAM MUNICIPAL CORPORATION

Short Tender Notice No.13/2026-27/SE(W-East)/EE-East/DB/GVMC/ Dt: 22-05-2026

01. No. of Works : 2 Nos
02. Value of works (ECV) : Rs.160.48 Lakhs
03. Down loading Starting Date : 23-05-2026 @02.00 P.M.
04. Down loading End Date : 01-06-2026 @ 02.00 P.M.
05. Last date for Submission of bid : 01-06-2026 @ 03.00 P.M.

Further details at <http://www.appeprocurement.gov.in>
O/o the Executive Engineer (PW-II) Division **For Commissioner, G.V.M.C.**

STATE HEALTH AGENCY (SHA KERALA)
5th & 8th Floor, Artech Meenakshi Plaza
Opp. Govt. W & C Hospital, Thycaud,
Thiruvananthapuram - 695 014
E mail - statehealthagencykerala@gmail.com
web : www.sha.kerala.gov.in
Ph. No. 0471 4063121

Tender id : 2026_SHA_852955_1
e- Tender Notice

Online Bids are invited from Eligible Third-Party Administrations/ Implementation's support Agencies (Licensed with IRDAI) for implementation of **Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana - Karunya Arogya Suraksha Padhati (AB PM- JAY KASP) and Other Health Schemes** in Private Hospitals. For details on e-Bids submission and tender document, visit the e-procurement portal (<https://etenders.kerala.gov.in>). Last date for submission of the completed e-bid documents: **12.06.2026** (up to 16.00 Hrs.) **Sd/- Executive Director**

Date : 26-05-2026

इण्डियन ओवरसीज बैंक
Indian Overseas Bank
अच्छी सेवा का स्वप्न सच हो Good people to grow with

Information Technology Department
Central Office: 763, Anna Salai, Chennai-600002

Indian Overseas bank (IOB) invites bids for the following:

GOVERNMENT E-MARKET PORTAL - PROCUREMENT OF 1069 CASH RECYCLERS UNDER BUYBACK MODEL

BID NO: GEM/2026/B/7575883 DATED 25.05.2026

The Above RFP tender document is available and can be downloaded from the following websites www.iob.bank.in & www.gem.gov.in For Tender details and future amendments, if any, keep referring to the following website www.gem.gov.in

इण्डियन ओवरसीज बैंक
Indian Overseas Bank
अच्छी सेवा का स्वप्न सच हो Good people to grow with

Information Technology Department
Central Office: 763, Anna Salai, Chennai-600002

Indian Overseas bank (IOB) invites bids for the following:

GOVERNMENT E-MARKET PORTAL - ENGAGEMENT OF CERT-IN EMPANELLED AUDITOR FOR CONDUCTING VULNERABILITY ASSESSMENT (VA) AND PENETRATION TESTING (PT) OF APPLICATIONS AND IT INFRASTRUCTURE

BID NO: GEM/2026/B/7569182 DATED 21.05.2026

The Above RFP tender document is available and can be downloaded from the following websites www.iob.bank.in & www.gem.gov.in For Tender details and future amendments, if any, keep referring to the following website www.gem.gov.in

भारत सरकार / GOVERNMENT OF INDIA, अंतरिक्ष विभाग / DEPARTMENT OF SPACE
विज्ञान साराभाई अंतरिक्ष केंद्र / VIKRAM SARABHAI SPACE CENTRE
निर्माण एवं अंतरिक्ष पुर्ण / CONSTRUCTION AND MAINTENANCE GROUP
तिरुवनन्तपुरम / THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - 22 / (फोन नं. / Ph. No. 0471 - 2564568 / 5689 / 4537 / 4545)

इं-निविदा की अवधि/Period of EXTENSION OF E-TENDER

1. उल्लंघन, बीएसएससी, तृष्णा में एन्जनीएरिंग एवम इंफ्रस्ट्रक्चर सुविधा के लिए भवन का निर्माण (निविदा, यांत्रिक तथा विद्युत कार्य) / Construction of building for NGLV Avionics and Integration Facility at TERLS, VSSC, Thumba (Civil, Mechanical & Electrical works) NIT No. VSSC/CMG/C01/03/2026-27 Dt. 22.04.2026 (फौ. ए. सी./P.A.C. ₹ 909.89 लाख/Lakhs)

डाउनलोड करने की अवधि/Period for downloading: दिनांक 04.06.2026 को 23.00 बजे तक बढ़ाए गए /Extended upto 23:00 hrs. on 04.06.2026

इच्छुक निविदाकार व्योरो के लिए www.tenderwizard.in/isro या www.isro.gov.in देखें। Interested tenderers may visit www.tenderwizard.in/isro or www.isro.gov.in for details.

Sd/- प्रधान, सीएमसी, बीएसएससी Head, CMG, VSSC

ODISHA CONSTRUCTION CORPORATION LTD.
(A Govt. of Odisha Undertaking)
CENTRAL WORKSHOP, RASULGARH,
Bhubaneswar-751010 (Odisha)
Tel- 0674 : 2580107, E-mail: gmocclcws@gmail.com
(GSTIN:21AAAC02571K2ZM)

"e"- Procurement Notice No. 04 /OCC/2026-27 (on-line)

Type of work : Design , manufacture, supply, installation, testing & commissioning of Radial Drilling machine with standard accessories for Fabrication shop of Central Workshop, Rasulgarh

Total No. of work : 01 (One).
Period of supply : 60 (Sixty) days.

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No.	Cost of Tender document (Including GST) through on-line transfer system	Availability of Tender (On-line)	Submission of Bid (On-line)
General Manager (Mech.), OCC Ltd., Central Workshop, Rasulgarh, Bhubaneswar	OCC/MECH/ CWS/ 02/2026-27	Rs.7,080/- (Non-refundable)	26.05.2026 10.00 AM to 09.06.2026 5.00 PM	26.05.2026 10.00 AM to 09.06.2026 5.00 PM

Date of opening of the Technical Bid : 10.06.2026 at 11.30 A.M.
Further details can be seen from the Govt. website (www.tendersodisha.gov.in)
Amendment/corrigendum/cancellation, if any shall be posted on-line only.

Sd/- General Manager (Mech.), OCC Ltd., Bhubaneswar
34001/261/2627 **OIPR-34001/34163/1/26-27/0005**

WREAKING HAVOC

RCB reaches fifth final with the second-biggest win in playoffs



SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

RCB's 92-run win against GT is the second biggest (by runs) in IPL playoffs after RR's 105-run victory over DD (2008 semifinal). This will be the Bengaluru outfit's fifth final and only CSK (10) and MI (6) have featured in more. Patidar emulated Dhoni, Rohit, Hardik and Shreyas in leading the side to back-to-back IPL finals.

RUNS GALORE

Batter Kohli and partner Kohli take centrestage in Qualifier 1



SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

Virat Kohli is the first batter with 600-plus runs in four successive seasons. With a tally of 9261, he now has more runs in the IPL than in Tests (9230). The number of 50-plus partnerships (7) between Kohli and Padikkal during this campaign is the joint second-most by a pair in a season behind du Plessis and Kohli (8 in 2023).

TRUE LEADER

'Cummins has guided Sakib and Praful through tough moments'



FILE PHOTO

SRH assistant coach James Franklin heaped praise on Pat Cummins, especially for guiding pacers Sakib Hussain and Praful Hinge. "As a captain who is a bowler, Pat really has a feel for when those two younger bowlers are under pressure. Pat's guidance through those moments is one of his strong traits as a leader".

TALKING STRAIGHT

Dhumal on the challenges and the way forward for the league



SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

IPL chairman Arun Dhumal admitted that in a 10-team format, it was ideal to have nine home and nine away games. He felt that logistical challenges and the commitment to bilateral series had made it tough to have a 94-game season, adding that they were looking at the possibility of moving the league to another window.

Patidar to the fore as RCB marches into summit clash

The skipper smashes an unbeaten 93 off just 33 balls as the defending champion racks up 254 for five, the highest ever in a playoff game, after being put in; GT gets bundled out for 162 in reply

IPL-19

Anish Pathiyil
DHARAMSHALA

Royal Challengers Bengaluru captain Rajat Patidar had told reporters ahead of the IPL 2026 Qualifier 1 against Gujarat Titans at the HPCA Stadium here that he was wrongly being typecast as a spin-hitter. Patidar reckoned his timing and shots were more suited to attacking the pacers. The 32-year-old provided a devastating glimpse of that with an unbeaten, counter-attacking 33-ball 93 that helped his side earn a commanding 92-run win on Tuesday and qualify for a second consecutive final.

Chasing RCB's mammoth total of 254 for five, the highest ever in an IPL playoff encounter, the Titans could only huff and puff to 162, crumbling against the opponent's frontline pace attack.

Setting the tone

After being asked to bat first, Venkatesh Iyer set the ball rolling with three boundaries in the first over. Virat Kohli found the going a lot tougher against Kagiso Rabada's short-of-a-length barrage, which eventually helped the South African pacer induce a miscue from Venkatesh and get the opening breakthrough.

Kohli and Devdutt Padikkal ensured the wicket didn't stem the flow of runs, finding the gaps regularly to take RCB to 76 for one at the end of the PowerPlay, but the momentum swung when Jason Holder removed both the batters in a space of three balls.

After seeing out Holder's spell, the introduction of the fifth bowler allowed Patidar and Krunal Pandya to play themselves in.

The Titans did not help their cause, committing a few errors on the field, including Patidar's dropped catch. The 95-run association between the pair gave the side the impetus it needed to accelerate at the death as the skipper and Jitesh Sharma finished on a high.

Unfortunate dismissal

After a prolonged delay due to a light show organised for the fans, GT suffered an unfortunate early setback when B. Sai Sudharsan was dismissed hit wicket after playing a crisp square cut.

Captain Shubman Gill, too, didn't trouble the scorers much, undone by a length ball that moved in from Bhuvneshwar Kumar.

For a side that relies heavily on the opening pair, the writing was on the wall early and the middle-order, minus Rahul Tewatia, could do nothing to prevent the inevitable.



Demolition job: Patidar made the most of an early drop to power Royal Challengers to a daunting total. Titans never got going as opener Sai Sudharsan was hit wicket off Duffy's bowling before Buttler was cleaned up by Hazlewood. Pacer Rasikh continued the good work by scalping a couple. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP



SCOREBOARD

ROYAL CHALLENGERS

Venkatesh Iyer c Gill b Rabada 19 (7b, 3x4, 1x6), Virat Kohli b Holder 43 (25b, 5x4, 1x6), Devdutt Padikkal c Buttler b Holder 30 (19b, 5x4), Rajat Patidar (not out) 93 (33b, 5x4, 9x6), Krunal Pandya c Sai Sudharsan b Rabada 43 (28b, 5x4, 2x6), Tim David b Prasidh 4 (5b), Jitesh Sharma (not out) 15 (5b, 1x4, 1x6); Extras (lb-1, lb-1, nb-2, w-3): 7; Total (for five wkts. in 20 overs): 254.

FALL OF WICKETS

1-21 (Venkatesh, 1.6 overs), 2-93 (Kohli, 8.2), 3-94 (Padikkal, 8.4), 4-189 (Krunal, 16.1), 5-214 (David, 17.6).

TITANS BOWLING

Siraj 3-0-46-0, Rabada 4-0-54-2, Holder 4-0-39-2, Rashid 3-0-29-0, Prasidh 4-0-53-1, Khejroliya 2-0-31-0.

GUJARAT TITANS

Sai Sudharsan hit wicket b Duffy 14 (9b, 3x4), Shubman Gill b Bhuvneshwar 2 (7b), Jos Buttler b Hazlewood 29 (11b, 4x4, 2x6), Nishant Sindhu c & b Rasikh 5 (3b, 1x4), Washington Sundar c Hazlewood b Duffy 8 (8b, 1x4), Jason Holder c Hazlewood b Rasikh 0 (3b), Rahul Tewatia (Impact Player for Khejroliya) c Patidar b Bhuvneshwar 68 (43b, 8x4, 4x6), Rashid Khan c Jitesh b Duffy 8 (9b, 1x6), Kagiso Rabada c Kohli b Krunal 9 (5b, 2x4), Mohammed Siraj c David b Krunal 5 (13b, 1x4), Prasidh Krishna (not out) 6 (7b, 1x4); Extras (lb-1, nb-1, w-6): 8; Total (in 19.3 overs): 162.

FALL OF WICKETS

1-17 (Sai Sudharsan, 2.3), 2-27 (Gill, 3.1), 3-51 (Buttler, 4.5), 4-51 (Nishant, 5.1), 5-51 (Holder, 5.4), 6-65 (Washington, 8.2), 7-78 (Rashid, 10.3), 8-88 (Rabada, 11.2), 9-156 (Tewatia, 18.1).

RCB BOWLING

Duffy 4-0-39-3, Bhuvneshwar 4-0-28-2, Hazlewood 4-0-39-1, Rasikh 3-1-24-2, Krunal 3-3-0-16-2, Shepherd (Impact Player for Duffy) 1-0-15-0.

Toss: Gujarat Titans.

Player-of-the-Match: Patidar. RCB won by 92 runs.

Fearless SRH and RR face off in Eliminator

Vivek Krishnan
NEW CHANDIGARH

Fearless, attacking cricket isn't just a throwaway expression for Sunrisers Hyderabad and Rajasthan Royals. It is embedded in their philosophies on the pitch, and has been central to much of their success in IPL 2026. The tension of a high-stakes Eliminator at the Maharaja Yadavindra Singh Stadium on Wednesday, the winner of which will advance to Qualifier 2 at the same venue, complicates the execution of an unfettered approach, but both these teams have built up to this moment to revel on occasions like these.

For Sunrisers, the no-holds-barred aggression with the bat has been shaped by the top four of Abhishek Sharma, Travis Head, Ishan Kishan and Heinrich Klaasen. Head may not have had his most productive campaign this year, but the performances of the other three have compensated adequately. With Klaasen, Kishan and Abhishek among the top 10 run-getters at the end of the league phase, SRH has been able to amass a total 200 or more as many as nine times, the joint-most alongside Punjab Kings this season. For Klaasen to have racked up 606 runs in the



Time to fire: Head, who has been inconsistent this season, will look to make it count in the Eliminator. R.V. MOORTHY

middle-order deserves special praise.

Such firepower, however, won't faze the rival camp. No situation, not even facing the peerless Jasprit Bumrah, has overawed particularly opener Vaibhav Sooryavanshi in a fledgling IPL career that

took flight a year ago. If the precocious teen grabs the spotlight in his maiden knockout game in the league, he will be adding another feather to an already-ornate cap.

Yashasvi Jaiswal and Dhruv Jurel have played solid supporting roles. On a

Today's match

ELIMINATOR

 vs 

New Chandigarh, 7.30 p.m.

HEAD-TO-HEAD

Played: 23

SRH 14 | RR 9

PREVIOUS MEETING

SRH won by five wickets, 2026

LIVE ON STAR SPORTS 1 & JIOHOTSTAR



Both opening pairs are destructive in their own ways... So I dare say both bowling line-ups have got their work cut out for them, but that makes the game exciting for everyone involved

JAMES FRANKLIN
SRH assistant coach

surface expected to yield plenty of runs, the bowling attacks will have to do their bit.

For SRH, the pace quartet of Pat Cummins, Eshan Malinga, Sakib Hussain and Praful Hinge has found a method to curtail the madness. In RR's case, Jofra Archer has had to largely carry the load. The many subplots should make for a box-office encounter.

Reading situations holds key: Shanaka

Vivek Krishnan
NEW CHANDIGARH

In Rajasthan Royals' run to the playoffs of IPL 2026, the middle-order has been its soft underbelly.

While the top three of Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, Yashasvi Jaiswal and Dhruv Jurel have compiled more than 350 runs each, no other batter has even managed a tally of 300 runs in the tournament's 19th edition.

All-rounder Dasun Shanaka, who has played five games this season, said that the middle-order batters need to take a bit of time to assess the situation.

"Most times, the top-order has done the job. It's about handling different situations. Following the top-order batters, who are playing at a high strike-rate, there is pressure. The batters in the middle-order need to take a bit of time to establish themselves. As someone who has played a lot of cricket there, I feel we need to stay in longer. That's the key to success in these tough situations," the 34-year-old Sri Lankan said on Tuesday, on the eve of RR's Eliminator against Sunrisers Hyderabad here.

Sabalenka, Gauff have it easy; Medvedev falls to a wildcard

FRENCH OPEN

Agence France-Presse
PARIS

Top seed Aryna Sabalenka and defending champion Coco Gauff began their French Open campaign with comfortable wins on Tuesday even as the men's sixth seed Daniil Medvedev went down in five sets to a wildcard.

Belarusian Sabalenka hurried through a 6-4, 6-2 win against Spanish World No. 50 Jessica Bouzas Maneiro as temperatures continued to soar.

"I'd say that for me always not easy, the first rounds. And then, as I get further in the tournament, as I get more comfortable, my level becomes better," said Sabalenka.

Gauff made short work of fellow American Taylor Townsend, kicking off her tournament with a clinical 6-4, 6-0 performance.

In the men's section, Russia's Medvedev lost 6-2, 1-6, 6-1, 1-6, 6-4 to Australian wildcard Adam Walton.

It was the seventh time in 10 French Open appearances that the former World No. 1 has fallen in the first round.



Gritty show: Walton put paid to Medvedev's aspirations with a marathon win. AFP

THE RESULTS

First round: Men: Kopriva (Cze) bt 30-Moutet (Fra) 6-3, 5-7, 6-4, 3-6, 6-3; Struff (Ger) bt 9-Bublik (Kaz) 7-5, 6-7(6), 6-4, 7-5; 18-Tien (USA) bt Garin (Chi) 6-0, 2-6, 6-0, 6-2. Arnaldi (Ita) bt 29-Griekspoor (Ned) 6-7(9), 6-3, 7-6(6), 6-3; Tsitsipas (Gre) bt Muller (Fra) 6-2, 3-0, retd.; Vallejo (Par) bt 20-Norrie (GBR) 7-6(7), 2-0, retd.; 16-Vacherot (Mon) bt Faurel (Fra) 6-3, 6-4, 3-6, 7-6(6); Walton (Aus) bt 6-Medvedev (Rus) 6-2, 1-6, 6-1, 1-6, 6-4; 5-Shelton (USA) bt Merida (Esp) 6-3, 6-3, 6-4; 10-Cobolli (Ita) bt Pellegrino (Ita) 6-4, 7-6(4), 6-3; 25-Cerundolo (Arg) bt van de Zandschulp (Ned) 6-3, 6-4, 6-7(7), 6-4; 11-Bublik (Rus) bt Buse (Per) 6-3, 6-7(6), 6-3, 7-5; 15-Ruud (Nor) bt Safiullin (Rus) 6-2, 7-6(5), 5-7, 0-6, 6-2; 24-Paul (USA) bt Hijikata (Aus) 4-6, 6-3, 7-5, 6-4; 32-Humbert (Fra) bt Mannarino (Fra) 6-3, 6-4, 6-3. Women: 16-Osaka (Jpn) bt Siegemund (Ger) 6-3, 7-6(3); 22-Kalinskaya (Rus) bt Boisson (Fra) 6-2, 6-2. 1-Sabalenka (Blr) bt Maneiro (Esp) 6-4, 6-2; 17-Jovic (USA) bt Eala (Phi) 6-4, 6-2; 4-Gauff (USA) bt Townsend (USA) 6-4, 6-0; Sakkar (Gre) bt 12-Noskova (Cze) 7-5, 7-6(3); 30-Li (USA) bt Zhang (Chn) 6-4, 6-2; 25-Shnaider (Rus) bt Zarazua (Mex) 6-4, 6-1; Osorio (Col) bt 14-Alexandrova (Rus) 6-2, 6-4; 6-Anisimova (USA) bt Rajaonah (Fra) 6-3, 6-1; 29-Ostapenko (Lat) bt Seidel (Ger) 6-4, 6-4; 10-Muchova (Cze) bt Zakharova (Rus) 7-5, 6-2. Fallen seeds: Men: 6-Medvedev, 9-Bublik, 20-Norrie, 29-Griekspoor, 30-Moutet. Women: 12-Noskova, 14-Alexandrova.



‘I should make a path on which people can walk and believe’

Gurindervir cautious not to repeat past mistakes, hopes to perform better and prove a point at the Asian Games later this year

Y.B. Sarangi
RANCHI

When Gurindervir Singh warmed up on the tracks while listening to religious Punjabi vaar (war) songs, prior to the men’s 100m final of the Federation athletics meet at the Birs Munda Stadium (Morabadi), his high energy level was unmistakable. The battle was two-fold for him. The Navyman wanted to get back the National record with a new mark while proving to the world that Indians can run fast.

The 25-year-old, hailing from Jalandhar, progressed in his mission by clocking 10.09, and becoming the first Indian to record a sub-10.10 time, while wrestling the National record from his closest rival and friend Animesh Kujur.

“I had self-belief, I had done hard training. I got good timing during training. The coach had belief that we could do it. Besides, the vaar songs playing into my ears took me to a different zone,” said Gurindervir.

Now, Gurindervir wants to run 100m even faster and emerge as a path-breaker like Milkha Singh and Neeraj Chopra.

“A lot of people think that Indians can’t sprint. Indians’ genes are not made for sprinting.

“Until Milkha Singh, there was no 400m champion. Milkha made a path and everyone started running on that path.

“Before Neeraj Chopra, there was no big name in javelin. When Neeraj won the Olympic gold medal, everyone wanted to do javelin. He broke the mental barrier that Indians can throw javelin and win gold in Olympics. Similarly, it is my wish, my dream that I should make a path on which people can walk and believe that we can do it too.”

Gurindervir admitted that he could not handle the success after breaking the National record (10.20, March 2025) for the first time and saw his performance dip.

“Last year, I was not a mature athlete...I could have achieved a lot. But my decisions were wrong. I chose something wrong. I made mistakes, but learned from my mistakes.

“Mentally, I am very strong this time. I will not back down soon. I have a support system. This time, there is no chance (of making mistakes). I have to carry this focus and mentality till the end.”

Reliance Foundation’s athletics director James Hillier adds perspective to this. “His mind wasn’t conditioned to break

the record. So what happened, it came as a bit of a surprise. It was just bombardment. It was so much pressure and he just wasn’t ready for it. He couldn’t deal with it, he couldn’t cope with it...We had some really difficult conversations and he has come back really well. He has learnt a lot from that and respect for him (for that).

“Sometimes the success is the worst thing that can happen to you. It puts a different level of pressure and expectation on you... he’ll manage this well. It won’t stifle him like it did last year, I’m absolutely sure of that. He’s a very mature young man now. In training, he has been brilliant. I can’t fault him, he has been fantastic. He deserves everything he gets.”

Hillier was confident that Gurindervir would improve his performance in the future. “We just keep pushing. In training, based on my models, anything from 10.06 to 10.10 is where I felt he could do, if he executed perfectly. So he’s still got a little bit more execution there, 10.09. We’ve got a little bit more based on how he is now.

“We expect him to improve this year, next year. I don’t know how long it’s going to take, but I do expect him to keep improving. The times are coming down, which is good.”

Healthy rivalry

Gurindervir loves his intense rivalry with Kujur. “I have been waiting for this for a long time. Every person enjoys watching a rivalry. Animesh has a hardcore fan base. When Animesh runs well, I feel that I have to run better. I have to do more hard training. When I run well, Animesh feels that he has to do more hard training. We get motivation from each other. We are roommates. We are brothers. We are competitors. When we are training, we are training partners. When we are out, we are friends.”

Talented bunch

Not just Kujur, but the presence of a bunch of talented sprinters like Manikanta Hoblihar and Pranav Gurav pushes the sprinters, including Gurindervir, to raise their level.

“If Gurindervir wants to win this competition, he has to run fast. If everyone else is running 10.05, he only needs to run 10.04. Now he knew Animesh ran 10.15, he needed to run faster than that to win. The guys have no choice now. 10.29s, 10.20s are getting bronze medals now. Five years ago, 10.50 was getting a gold medal. The whole thing is moving on. It’s a very, very exciting

time for Indian sprinting,” said Hillier.

Gurindervir feels better infrastructure would help athletes perform even better. “If this was a Mondo track with a good warm-up area and a good ground facility, then the races would start looking good.”

Gurindervir, who was inspired by seeing one his father’s action pictures and trophies earned as a National-level volleyball player before taking up sport, got further motivated by watching Usain Bolt’s 2008 Beijing Olympics feats and Yohan Blake’s running technique and weight training.

Gurindervir is happy to receive his family’s support and understanding. “I explained to my father this is how it is. Then he understood, now he knows everything. How does the 100m run happen, how does the body open, when does the race start. Like I ran 10.40 in Delhi, but he had no stress. He said, ‘No problem, our target is something else. You rely on training and the race will start on its own.’”

For Gurindervir and Hillier, apart from the Commonwealth Games, the Asian Games is a major target this season. If Gurindervir is able to repeat his sub-10.10 performance in these big Games, then not only will he make a name for himself but will also succeed in his mission to let the world know that Indian sprinters can also run fast.

THE GIST

- Gurindervir, hailing from Jalandhar, clocked 10.09 and became the first Indian to record a sub-10.10 time in the 100m
- The 25-year-old wants to emerge as a path-breaker like Milkha Singh and Neeraj Chopra
- If Gurindervir is able to repeat his 100m performance in big competitions, he will let the world know that Indian sprinters, too, can run fast



Gurindervir, inspired by his father’s action pictures and trophies won as a National-level volleyball player, was further motivated by watching Usain Bolt’s 2008 Beijing Olympics feats and Yohan Blake’s running technique and weight training

Dog brains shrank significantly by 5,000 years ago, thanks to humans

Dogs face pressure to evolve from predators, foraging, and mating, but domestication relaxes all of them; the high energy cost of neural tissues combined with the lower cognitive demands of a captive environment results in smaller brains in domesticated animals

Jay Kakade

Domestic dogs have significantly smaller brains than their wolf ancestors. Researchers have long known that dogs' brains shrank in the past, but when has been a mystery. Some theories also argue that strict aesthetic standards and intensive, selective modern breeding over the last 200 years could have been the cause.

In a new study, researchers from Europe have suggested that canines' brains had already shrunk by at least 5,000 years ago – and possibly due to human interference.

During the Upper Pleistocene period, around 35,000 years ago, and long before humans started settled agriculture, dogs and wolves had similar brain sizes. This was around when humans and dogs began to interact more often. But by the Late Neolithic period, around 5,000 years ago, by when agricultural societies had become widespread, dogs living in Western European settlements had brains nearly 46% smaller than those of wolves at the same time, the researchers reported on April 29 in *Royal Society Open Science*.

They noticed this shrinkage in the remains of dogs in a Middle/Late Neolithic site in Chalais in France.

This study provides “new evidence” for the evolutionary reduction in the brain size of dogs that correlates with their domestication, Ian Kuijt, a zooarchaeologist at the University of Notre Dame in Indiana, who was not involved in the research, said.

“It is fascinating to see the overall trajectory, even if this is a very small sample,” he added.

Virtual endocasts

To trace how dog brains evolved, Thomas Cucchi, a bioarchaeologist at the French National Centre for Scientific Research (CNRS), Paris, and his colleagues and peers analysed the skulls of 185 modern and 22 prehistoric wolf and dog specimens. The specimens included two dog-like animals from about 35,000 and 15,000 years ago, and Late Neolithic wolves and dogs from about 5,000 to 4,500 years ago.

The researchers used this data to create virtual endocasts – models of the space inside the skull where the brain once sat.

Even though, the brain decomposes rapidly after death, the skull's inner cavity preserves an imprint of the brain's size and general shape, so the endocast served as a proxy for the brain, Eniko Kubinyi, a biologist at Eotvos Lorand University in Hungary and another author of the study, said.

Using the volume of these endocasts and the skull size, the team could track how brain size, relative to body size,



Evolution drop: Researchers have found that dogs' brains shrunk disproportionate to the drop in their body sizes. DAVID VIVES/UNSPLASH

changed at different points of time.

The endocranial volume of the so-called ‘protodogs’ from the Pleistocene did not indicate the smaller brain seen in later dogs. This, the researchers said, could mean they were still more wolflike than doglike.

One specimen from a cave site called Goyet in Belgium had a slightly larger brain volume than that of contemporary wolves. Dr. Cucchi said this might be due to increased human interaction at the beginning of the domestication process that posed new cognitive challenges.

Disproportionate drop

As humans transitioned from hunter-gatherers to a settled lifestyle around 5,000 years ago, dogs in Western European farming settlements adapted as well, becoming widely domesticated as a result.

Dogs face pressure to evolve from predators, foraging, and mating, but domestication relaxes all of them. The high energy cost of neural tissues combined with the lower cognitive demands of a captive environment results in smaller brains in domesticated animals.

That said, the researchers found that dogs' brains shrunk disproportionate to the drop in their body sizes – so much so that their brains were as big as those of Chihuahuas and pugs today. The researchers did note that the samples from Chalais alone were based on eight to ten dogs, meaning the findings from here alone cannot be generalised.

Previous studies have suggested that

As humans transitioned from hunter-gatherers to a settled lifestyle, dogs adapted as well, becoming widely domesticated as a result; a recent study provides 'new evidence' for the evolutionary reduction in the brain size of dogs that correlates with their domestication

when brain size drops drastically, brain regions are reorganised. Often, this means a smaller cortical brain – which is responsible for learning, self-control, and cognitive ability – and a larger subcortical brain, which is involved in controlling emotions, Dr. Cucchi said.

Extrapolating from neuroanatomical research and studies of modern breeds, the researchers also suggested that the reorganisation resulted in dogs that were likely less trainable but more anxious, fearful, and prone to barking. Since small-brained dogs are more temperamental and wary of everything, they could have served the purpose of alerting humans to unusual activities nearby, Dr. Cucchi said by way of one example of a role they could have played.

Dr. Kuijt noted that dog skulls and mandibles had also been found in refuse pits, meaning they were likely used as food as well.

“The link with changing temperaments serving as an alarm system is an intriguing speculation, but of course

inferring behaviours from the archaeological and palaeontological records is challenging,” Michael Buckley, a bioarchaeologist at the University of Manchester, who was not involved in the study, said.

A dingo story

The study also examined dingoes, the East Asian dogs introduced to Australia and which returned to the wild at least 3,300 years ago. They have since been living largely independent of humans. Despite this long separation, dingoes' brain volumes are between the smallest and largest-brained modern dogs, and larger than village dogs of comparable skull size.

According to experts, this suggests living as a free-ranging apex predator and facing the cognitive demands of hunting and survival without human support may have exerted some positive selection pressure favouring larger brains.

However, dingoes have not regained the brain size seen in wolves.

Even though dingoes could grow a larger brain, Dr. Kubinyi said, “brain tissue is metabolically very costly [to maintain], so brain size is unlikely to increase without strong selection pressure.”

Since dingoes do not rely on cooperative hunting against large and dangerous prey the way wolves do, “it seems that dingoes do not need a larger brain for their survival,” she added.

(Jay Kakade is a freelance science writer. jaykakade28@gmail.com)

THE GIST

During the Upper Pleistocene period, around 35,000 years ago, and long before humans started settled agriculture, dogs and wolves had similar brain sizes

But by the Late Neolithic period, around 5,000 years ago, by when agricultural societies had become widespread and well after dogs and humans began interacting, dogs living in Western European settlements had brains nearly 46% smaller than those of wolves at the same time

Previous studies have suggested that when brain size drops drastically, brain regions are reorganised

Researchers also suggest that the reorganisation resulted in dogs that were likely less trainable, but more anxious, fearful, and prone to barking, serving the purpose of alerting humans to unusual activities nearby

BIG SHOT



Floral bloom: Swans search for food in the waters of the Liptovska Mara dam, where sections are covered with green plants due to reduced fresh water supply, near the village of Liptovska Sielnica in Slovakia, on May 24. The recent heatwave has caused water levels to drop by several metres, leaving the shores covered in flowers and grass. AFP

WHAT IS IT?

Sea level: hands on a skater

Vasudevan Mukunth

A new study in *JGR Solid Earth* has suggested that climate change is changing the distribution of water and ice in a way that may be affecting how long one day is on the earth more dramatically than scientists expected.

The study's authors, from Austria and Switzerland, analysed palaeoclimate records going back 3.6 million years along with a new deep-learning method to understand how the sea levels changed over time.

Just as a spinning skater can slow down by extending their arms, changes in the distribution of water between the oceans and the ice sheets can, in small ways, alter how fast the earth rotates.

Scientists have long known that the moon, the earth's atmosphere, and even processes deep underground influence the length of day. The contribution of climate change however remains poorly understood.

In the study, the researchers combined climate models with proxies for the earth's past climate, including geological evidence from fossils, to estimate the sea level at various points of time since the Late Pliocene epoch. According to the team, modern climate change may be increasing the length of day at a rate among the fastest in the last 3.6 million years: around 1.33 ms per



Scientists have long known that the moon, the earth's atmosphere, and even processes deep underground influence the length of day. NASA

century. That is roughly 13 microseconds per year. This is just the climate-induced component of the change. At this pace, it would take around 75,000-80,000 years one day to become one second longer. Of course, in the meantime, the rate at which a day is lengthening may also increase.

For feedback and suggestions for 'Science', please write to science@thehindu.co.in with the subject 'Daily page'

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Persons rescued after fire engulfed building in Delhi's Rohini area

23 Twenty-three people were rescued and two injured after a fire broke out in a four-storey residential building in Delhi's Rohini on Tuesday morning. The blaze, suspected to have started in the electricity meter section on the ground floor, spread thick smoke through the building, trapping residents on balconies before firefighters evacuated them safely. PTI

California residents return as chemical tank threat eases

50,000 After the threat of a toxic chemical tank explosion in Garden Grove reduced, the authorities in Southern California have eased evacuation orders. Around 50,000 residents were initially evacuated. Officials said there is no active leak from the tank containing methyl methacrylate. AFP

Amount approved for industrial projects across Maharashtra

89,731 in ₹ crore. The Maharashtra government approved incentives for five mega and ultra-mega industrial projects worth ₹89,731 crore on Tuesday. The projects, linked to sectors such as solar manufacturing, electric steel and synthetic graphite materials, are expected to create around 20,000 direct and indirect jobs. PTI

Quarantine duration set for Congo, Uganda travellers to Thailand

21 Thailand imposed a mandatory 21-day quarantine for travellers arriving from or transiting through the Democratic Republic of Congo and Uganda amid a worsening Ebola outbreak. The move follows hundreds of suspected Ebola cases and deaths in the DRC, with Thai authorities citing risks linked to international travel and population movement. AFP

Forest areas scorched during Uttarakhand forest fire season

375 Uttarakhand recorded 375 forest fire incidents between February 15 and May 24, affecting 319.67 hectares across the State. Chamoli emerged as the worst-hit district, while officials said satellite monitoring, 1,438 crew stations and 5,600 fire watchers were being used to strengthen firefighting efforts. PTI
COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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The judiciary's role in complete justice

The Supreme Court is empowered under Article 142 to pass necessary orders to deliver complete justice where existing laws fail to provide a specific remedy. While this power acts as a 'constitutional safety valve', critics argue that it may lead to judicial encroachment upon the domain of the Executive or the Legislature

LETTER & SPIRIT

C.B.P. Srivastava

Another milestone in the direction of delivery of complete justice by the Supreme Court of India is its recent decision to elevate the Right to safe travel on National Highways as a fundamental right, declaring it an integral part of the Right to Life under Article 21 of the Constitution. The Court took *suo motu* cognisance of two road accidents in November 2025, which led to a loss of 34 lives and has issued wide-ranging directives. [In *Re: Phalodi Accident vs. National Highways Authority of India and Others* (2025)]. The Court has clearly held that safe, well-maintained, and motorable roads are no longer just a policy goal, but a constitutional obligation of the state. It is an alarming fact that while National Highways comprise only 2% of roads, they account for 30% of fatalities. In 2025, National Highways in India saw approximately 26,770 deaths in the first six months alone. The government aims to reduce road accidents by 50% by 2030 and to achieve this goal, it has adopted a strategy focusing on strengthening Education, Engineering (roads/vehicles), Enforcement, and Emergency Medical Service has been adopted. Despite fatalities on the National Highways decreasing by 11% compared to 2024, they still remain alarmingly high. These figures must have been a contributing factor in the Supreme Court's decision while exercising its inherent power under Article 142 of the Constitution which talks about complete justice.

Inherent power of the Supreme Court The Supreme Court is the custodian of the Constitution. Hence, it has been given such powers which could be exercised where the law is silent or is found incapable of grievance redressal. Such powers are not conferred by statute but



The power to deliver complete justice is residuary in nature. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

are inherent to its role as the highest court, enabling it to go beyond strict procedural constraints to prevent injustice or abuse of process. Another condition to invoke Article 142 is a manifest error and non-exercise of it might lead to travesty of justice. The Supreme Court in *Delhi Judicial Service Association vs. State of Gujarat* (1991) has held that the power to do complete justice is entirely of different level and of a different quality. The Court further says that any restrictions contained in ordinary laws cannot act as limitation on the constitutional power of the Court.

The concept of complete justice

A pertinent question that comes to our mind is whether justice could ever be incomplete. If not, then why has the term 'complete justice' been incorporated into Clause (1) of Article 142 of the Constitution? Another question that may arise is whether High Courts may also deliver complete justice.

The power to deliver complete justice is residuary in nature and it may be exercised to ensure the observance of due

process of law. This is an extraordinary jurisdiction implicitly vested with trust and faith that it shall be exercised by applying the principle of natural justice, i.e., fairness. The Court also recognises its significance, and therefore, held in *Hitesh Bhatnagar vs. Deepa Bhatnagar* (2011) that extraordinary care and caution shall be observed while exercising this jurisdiction.

Article 142 empowers the Supreme Court to pass any necessary order to deliver comprehensive, equitable justice, even if existing laws or procedural technicalities do not provide a specific remedy. This power acts as a "constitutional safety valve" to fill legal gaps. It is a well-established fact that the Constitution of India gives precedence to natural justice over other forms of justice. In a landmark judgment, the apex court, in *Canara Bank vs. Debasis Das* (2003), says that the Constitution intends to deliver substantive justice, which is the removal of injustices and it shall be delivered either by way of legal or natural justice. In a situation where legal justice is incapable of doing so, the principles of

natural justice must be followed.

Complete justice and High Courts

The question of whether High Courts could also deliver complete justice may be answered on the basis of the Supreme Court's decision in *Anil Kumar Jain vs. Maya Jain* (2009) in which the Court held that the powers of High Courts under Article 226 of the Constitution are certainly not at par with those of the Supreme Court under Article 142. However, justice is a wide concept and shall always be complete. Thus, the High Courts may also deliver complete justice, though in a more circumscribed manner than the Supreme Court, whose inherent powers under Article 142 serve as one of the tools for applying the concept of due process of law in rapidly changing social, economic, political and value systems within and outside India.

Cause for controversy

The exercise of Article 142 is often criticised as judicial overreach that undermines the principle of separation of powers. Critics point out that the Court bypasses the established laws and procedures and may encroach upon the domain of the Executive or the Legislature. However, such criticisms do not have much rationale. It is true that invoking Article 142 makes the judiciary more active. However, judicial activism involves the proactive and progressive interpretation of laws or constitutional provisions. Its constitutional intent is to deliver justice, be it social, economic, political or legal. The problem arises when new and evolving social realities, such as live-in relationships or matters relating to homosexuality, emerge and established laws and procedures may prove inadequate to deliver justice. In such situations the Supreme Court, as the custodian of the Constitution needs to proactively take steps to ensure that complete justice is delivered. (C.B.P. Srivastava is President, Centre for Applied Research in Governance, Delhi)

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▼ The Supreme Court of India, as the custodian of the Constitution, has been given such powers which could be exercised where the law is silent or is found incapable of grievance redressal.

▼ The Court's power to deliver complete justice is residuary in nature, and it may be exercised to ensure the observance of due process of law. It is an extraordinary jurisdiction implicitly vested with trust and faith that it shall be exercised by applying the principle of natural justice.

The global impact of Indonesia's export policy shift

The country has announced that key commodities will soon be exported only through a state-run agency

Sonikka Loganathan

In a major overhaul of trade policy, resource-rich Indonesia announced that key commodities can soon only be exported via a state-run agency. Speaking to Parliament on May 20, President Prabowo Subianto said the Government Regulation on Natural Resource Commodity Export Governance, as the measure is called, would mean that the Indonesian Government will be the sole exporter of natural resource products, beginning with palm oil, coal and ferro alloys.

The new policy requires the resource producers to sell their commodities to PT Danantara Sumberdaya Indonesia, a state-run agency under the sovereign wealth fund Danantara. From here, the agency will engage in transactions with foreign buyers, eradicating direct sales between private resource companies and international buyers. Analysts say the announcement signals

tightening of the government's grip over the Indonesian economy. Indonesia is the world's biggest producer and exporter of palm oil and thermal coal, and a major source of nickel. The move has sent commodities markets into a frenzy, with experts warning that its impact will be felt globally. The centralisation is set to come into effect by September, with a transition period of three months beginning in June.

In his address, Mr. Prabowo said Indonesia had lost over \$900 billion in revenue over the past 34 years because of fraud and under-invoicing. The new mandate would give the state control over the tax revenue and pricing, while strengthening overall oversight to to minimise revenue leaks. Despite being resource-rich, Indonesia has struggled to convert that wealth into consistent economic growth, with state revenue-to-GDP at around 12%, whereas the Asia-Pacific average is 19.5%, and the OECD average is 33.9%. Increasing tax revenue and plugging leaks allows for

investment into the country's development goals and supports its reserves. The plan's State controlled pricing would also ensure fair transfer pricings.

Market response

Following Mr. Prabowo's announcement, Indonesian stocks dropped to the lowest in over a year. The Jakarta Composite Index fell by 2.4% on May 20, with major declines in energy and mining firms.

Traders and buyers are still understanding the impact of the decision and how the immediate changes will unfold. The commodities in question are vital to daily life and found in products globally. Palm oil is used globally in everything from processed foods to cosmetics, and half of the world's thermal coal exports in 2025 came from Indonesia, with China, India, Vietnam and the Philippines being the top importers. Shortages in LNG supply because of the standstill in Iran is further

pushing Asian nations, like Japan and South Korea, to lean on coal to fill energy gaps. China, in particular, is a major buyer of Indonesian nickel pig iron, a cheap alternative that is used in stainless steel production. The mineral is also a key material used in electric vehicle manufacturing. Ahead of Mr. Prabowo's announcement, the China Chamber of Commerce in Indonesia, a group representing Chinese companies, wrote a five-page letter to the President, regarding their fears over the rise in "excessively stringent regulation, over-enforcement and even corruption and extortion by competent authorities."

Concerns over the centralisation

In 2020, the then administration banned the export of raw nickel ore. The move intended to force global companies to invest in Indonesian nickel processing plants, thereby increasing the value of exports and bringing more revenue into the country. Last year, Jakarta created Danantara, the country's second sovereign wealth fund which has become an instrumental part of Indonesia's economic policy. However, it has done little to soothe investors about its commitment and staying power, especially in the face of political uncertainty and corruption risks.

Similar worries have been raised now. Private companies are expected to be hit hardest, as the state-run agency monopolises their role.

THE GIST

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